SX2.3 Power Drawbar – Design

Oct 26, 2026 · @Russell Brett

A floating-yoke pneumatic drawbar for TTS tooling on the SX2.3 R8 spindle. A Belleville stack clamps the collet; an air cylinder driving a 9.5° wedge (6:1) releases it through a closed force loop, so the spindle bearings carry no release load. The wedge was chosen over a 6:1 lever, which is kept in Appendix B for reference.

Design basis

The design is fixed by six requirements and the measured machine data below. Measurements are from the 25–26 Oct measurement sheet; "pending" items wait on the new 3/4" collet.

Requirements

1. Zero release load through the spindle bearings, quill, rack or pinion: the release force closes inside a spindle–collet–drawbar–actuator loop.
2. Clamp TTS holders (19.00 mm shanks) with a Belleville stack; target preload 6.7–8.9 kN (1,500–2,000 lbf), Hoss's guidance for TTS on small mills.
3. Release by pushing the drawbar down only; no rotation.
4. Release reliably with the regulator at 5.0 bar. Supply is 90 psi (6.2 bar) at 9 CFM, so this allows for line drop and the compressor sitting near cut-in.
5. No contact with the spindle while it turns; release blocked unless the spindle is stopped.
6. Removable, so the machine can revert to a manual drawbar.

Machine data

Item	Value	Status
Spindle taper	R8	Measured
Collet	3/4" flat-nose TTS R8, M12 × 1.75 (received 7 Nov 2026)	On order
TTS shank diameter	19.00 mm, genuine and copies	Measured
Spindle top	6-spline, 21.9 mm over crests, no thread	Measured
Spindle bore at top	13.1 mm	Measured
Spindle stick-up above pulley	64 mm	Measured
Pulley	64 mm OD, 22 mm tall, splined to spindle	Measured
Drawbar seat	Spindle end face	Measured
Quill	Locked fully up under CNC; Z moves the head	Confirmed
Head top	255 × 115 mm; spindle 60 mm from front, centred	Measured
Mounting	12 mm base plate on the flat head top: 4 × M6 tapped through the 9 mm casting, 2 × Ø6 dowels (decided 29 Oct 2026)	Proposed
Headroom	Over 1,000 mm	Measured

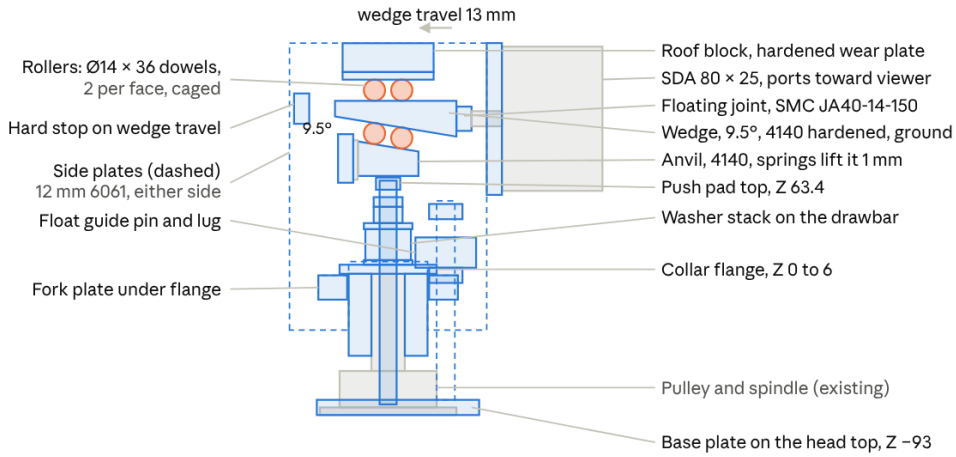
Item	Value	Status
Existing drawbar	7/16-20 UNF, 250 mm rod + 15 mm head, 11.5 mm body	Measured
Collet stick-out (sample)	3.8 mm proud of spindle nose, clamped (sample collet; the flat-nose collet is still to measure)	Measured
Holder flange to spindle nose	2 mm gap (sample collet; recheck with the flat-nose collet)	Measured
Release stroke	—	Pending
Holder counterbore depth	2.0 mm rebate in holder face	Measured
Air supply	90PSI air is available at up to 9CFM.	Confirmed

Concept layout

The yoke hooks under the spindle cap and pushes the drawbar down through the wedge, so the cylinder's reaction never leaves the yoke–cap–spindle–drawbar loop.

The wedge does the lever's job in a box under 200 mm tall

Seen from the machine's left (front to the right), about 1 px per mm; the cylinder pushes the wedge rearward. Draft.



8 × Tormach 31319: push pad top Z 63.4, anvil Z 64.4, box top about Z 152; head top Z −93 (measured).
The float guide pin is dashed: it stands outside the side plate, at 47 mm from the spindle axis.

wedge actuator · side view, draft

At rest the fork and the anvil both sit clear by their running gaps, so nothing touches the turning spindle. One float spring and guide pin is drawn; there is one on each side of the head.

Force path

At every phase the net axial force on the spindle is zero, so the bearings see no release load. W is the washer preload, F the actuator squeeze force (yoke pulls the cap up by F, wedge pushes the drawbar down by F), P the force to push the collet out of the taper. This is a free-body analysis of the concept, not a measured result.

Phase	Condition	Cap shoulder on spindle face	Collet pull on taper	Spindle clamp load	Net on spindle
0. Running	F = 0, gaps open	W down	W up	0	0
1. Squeeze	0 < F < W	W − F down	W − F up	0	0
2. Release	F = W	0	0	0	0
3. Push-out	F > W, collet moving	0	P down (friction)	P up	0
4. Hard stop	Wedge on its stop	0	P down	P up	0

Three consequences drive the detail design:

- **The cap clamp only ever carries P**, the collet push-out force, never W. P is small for a non-locking R8 taper; the "taper break effort" test on the measurement sheet gives a first feel for it.
- **A hard stop on the yoke ends the stroke.** Any cylinder force beyond what the stroke needs goes into the stop, inside the yoke. It never reaches the drawbar, the cap clamp or the washers. The same stop caps washer deflection at its allowable limit.
- **The yoke floats.** It rests on stop collars on two guide pins standing on the head-top base plate, and lifts off them by the hook gap when it actuates, so the cylinder reaction stays in the yoke. The head carries only the yoke's weight and the hold-down spring force; the spindle carries nothing.

The principle follows Hoss's floating drawbar (PDB v2 / PDB3) and Shane Wighton's X2 design, which pulls against a flange on the spindle with a running gap.

Components

Eight parts make up the drawbar; dimensions here are preliminary and get fixed once the release stroke and washer choice are known.

Component	Design	Still to fix
Spindle cap	Two-piece clamp collar, 52 mm OD, bore a slip fit on the 21.9 mm spline crests. Internal shoulder seats on the spindle end face and centres the drawbar; the washers sit on its top face. Clamp of 3 × M8 per side grips the spline crests. External flange for the yoke hook. Sits at least 5 mm clear of the pulley.	Length, flange size, clamp holding vs P
Drawbar	4140 high-tensile. M12 × 1.75 to the collet (changed from 7/16-20 on 7 Nov 2026 to suit the collet supplied); 11.0 mm body through the 13.1 mm spindle bore; 12.0 mm centring land in the cap shoulder; 11.2 mm guide section through the washer stack; 7/16-20 top thread; heavy preload nut plus jam nut; hardened push pad on top.	Overall length, collet thread engagement
Washer stack	8 × genuine Tormach 31319, singly in series, guided on the drawbar, hardened thrust washers at each end. Preload set by measured stack height, cross-checked against Tormach's two turns past hand-tight.	Fixed at 8; if the stroke is too long, fit a genuine Tormach collet

Component	Design	Still to fix
Housing (yoke)	Housing straddling the cap. Forked lower plate hooks under the cap flange with a 0.5–1 mm running gap. Side plates carry the roof block, rollers, wedge and cylinder mount plate. A hard stop on the wedge ends the stroke.	Settled: see the side plate, fork and stop block drawings
Wedge and rollers	A 9.5° hardened 4140 wedge, pushed rearward by the cylinder, runs between two pairs of Ø14 × 36 hardened rollers: the upper pair under the roof wear plate, the lower pair on the anvil, which presses the push pad. Springs hold the anvil 1 mm clear at rest.	Ratio 6:1, fixed by the wedge angle
Cylinder	SDA 80 × 25 compact cylinder (Airtac pattern, already owned; the SDA 80 × 30 bought from AliExpress is now a spare), double-acting, rubber bumpers. Front face bolted to the housing mount plate; a floating joint couples the rod to the wedge.	Body 94.07 mm square × 66.1 mm, measured; mounting and rod-end threads: see Cylinder
Mounts	A 12 mm base plate on the head top, fixed with 4 × M6 into new holes tapped through the 9 mm casting top and located by 2 × Ø6 dowels; it carries two guide pins, so the head side walls need no new holes. Vertical guide pins; the yoke slides on bronze bushes and rests on adjustable stop collars that set the hook gap; light springs hold it down against Z-axis decelerations.	Settled: see the base plate drawing and List B row 20
Controls	5/2 solenoid valve, 24 VDC, with meter-out flow controls to stop the cylinder slamming. Filter-regulator. Release button on the front faceplate, wired through the casting. Valve enabled only when the CNC controller reports spindle stopped; the same output can later serve an M-code tool-change macro.	Controller signal (24 VDC for the valve comes from the control supply's spare output)

Sizing

On the working assumptions below, the SDA 80 × 25 cylinder with the 6:1 wedge and the regulator at 5.0 bar does the job; a 63 mm bore would fall short at that pressure. The numbers firm up once the release stroke and washer datasheet are in.

Method

Design release force at the drawbar, where F_stack(x) is the stack force at deflection x (from the washer datasheet), s_p the preload deflection, s_r the release stroke:

$$F_d = F_{stack}(s_p + s_r) + P$$

Cylinder force, with mechanical advantage i and efficiency η (0.9 assumed):

$$F_{cyl} \geq \frac{F_d}{i\,\eta}$$

Cylinder bore at the design pressure p_min = 0.50 MPa (5.0 bar regulator setting; supply is 6.2 bar):

$$D = \sqrt{\frac{4\,F_{cyl}}{\pi\,p_{min}}}$$

Cylinder stroke, with g the pusher running gap:

$$h_{cyl} \geq i\,(s_r + g) + \text{margin}$$

Washer limit, with h0 the free cone height and n washers in series (confirm the allowable fraction on the supplier datasheet):

$$s_p + s_r \leq 0.75\,h_0\,n$$

Cylinder output (theoretical, F = p × A; last two columns apply a 6:1 wedge at η = 0.9)

Bore (mm)	5.0 bar (N)	6.2 bar (N)	At drawbar, 5.0 bar (kN)	At drawbar, 6.2 bar (kN)
50	982	1,217	5.3	6.6
63	1,559	1,933	8.4	10.4
80 (SDA 80 × 25)	2,513	3,116	13.6	16.8
100	3,927	4,869	21.2	26.3

Working example (illustrative inputs, to be replaced by measured values)

- Preload W = 8.2 kN; stack force at release 11.7 kN (8 Tormach washers at a 1.2 mm stroke, next section); push-out P = 0.5 kN; so F_d = 12.2 kN.
- At i = 6: F_cyl = 2.27 kN, so D = 76 mm at 5.0 bar. Next standard bore up is 80 mm: 13.6 kN at the drawbar, 11% margin, and an expected release pressure of about 4.5 bar.
- Stroke: s_r = 1.2 mm, g = 1 mm, i = 6, so i(s_r + g) = 13.2 mm, well within the SDA's 25 mm stroke (the hard stop needs 15 mm, and even the washer-flat limit of about 1.9 mm needs only 17.4 mm). With 8 washers the stroke limit is the washers going flat at about 2 mm, not the cylinder.
- At the full 6.2 bar the 80 mm cylinder at 6:1 can deliver about 16.8 kN at the drawbar; everything above F_d ends in the hard stop. Air use is about 0.8 L of free air per release, negligible against 9 CFM (about 255 L/min).
- Drawbar thread stress at 8.2 kN: M12 × 1.75 tensile stress area about 84.3 mm² (ISO 898-1 thread tables, from memory), so about 97 MPa, well under the roughly 600 MPa proof stress of grade 8 / 8.8 material.

Drawbar and washer stack

Eight genuine Tormach 31319 washers, stacked singly in series and guided on the drawbar, give 8.2 kN preload: the same count Tormach fits on its own PCNC power drawbar with an R8 TTS collet. With the 6:1

wedge at 5.0 bar they release strokes up to about 1.2 mm with 10% margin, or about 1.6 mm at 5.5 bar. If the release test needs more, fit a genuine Tormach collet before adding washers.

Why 30 mm high-load washers, not DIN 2093. DIN 2093 ties OD to bore at about 2:1, so DIN washers that fit a 7/16" drawbar are 22–25 mm OD and carry only 2–3 kN. Bolt-joint Bellevilles are thicker for their size and carry about five times the load in the same bore. Appendix A lists suppliers.

Reference washers

Washer	OD (mm)	Bore (mm)	t (mm)	Free height (mm)	h0 (mm)	Flat load (kN)	Mass, calculated (g)
Solon 7H89, 7/16" size	30.2	11.4	2.44	3.07	0.64	15.1	about 11.7
Tormach 31319 (measured by viking45)	30.1	11.5	2.3	2.9	0.6	not published	about 11

Release range, 8 washers (8 × Tormach 31319, 6:1 wedge, P = 0.5 kN; forces assume the Solon 7H89 rate)

Release stroke (mm)	Release deflection	Release force (kN)	Required incl. P (kN)	Margin at 5.0 bar (13.6 kN)	Margin at 5.5 bar (14.9 kN)
0.8	0.75 h0	10.6	11.1	23%	35%
1.0	0.79 h0	11.2	11.7	16%	28%
1.2	0.83 h0	11.7	12.2	11%	22%
1.4	0.87 h0	12.3	12.8	6%	16%
1.6	0.91 h0	12.9	13.4	1%	11%
1.8	0.96 h0	13.5	14.0	Won't release	7%

The table assumes the 31319 behaves like the same-size Solon 7H89 (23.6 kN/mm per washer, so 2.95 kN/mm for the stack), with h0 = 0.6 mm from viking45's measurement; Tormach doesn't publish a load rating. Preload sits at 0.35 mm per washer (0.58 h0), the stack is 23.2 mm free and 20.4 mm preloaded, and the washers go flat after about 2.0 mm of stroke. Set the hard stop at s_r + 0.3 mm and never beyond about 1.9 mm. Releasing at 0.8–0.9 h0 is deeper than a longer stack would need, but it is how Tormach runs the same washers: it calls for a monthly crack check, immediate replacement of damaged washers, and anti-seize between washers every 5,000 cycles or six months. Keep a spare set. The first release test at stepped pressure measures the real force.

Rotating mass and imbalance (my estimates; worst case assumes every washer sits to one side of its guide clearance)

	DIN A50 stack (rejected)	8 × Tormach 31319
Stack mass	about 520 g	about 88 g
Guide	Cap bore, 0.6 mm diametral clearance	Drawbar, about 0.2 mm
Worst-case unbalance	about 156 g·mm	about 9 g·mm
Rotating force at 2,500 rpm	about 11 N	about 0.6 N

For scale, ISO 21940-11 grade G2.5, typical for machine-tool spindles (from memory), allows about 30 g·mm for a 3 kg rotor at 2,500 rpm. Rotating force grows with speed squared.

Axial stack-up above the spindle end face (8 washers, preloaded, at rest; nut heights from standard tables, from memory)

Item	Height (mm)	Top above spindle end face (mm)
Cap shoulder	6.0	6.0
Base thrust washer, hardened, 32 OD	3.0	9.0
Washer stack, 8 preloaded	20.4	29.4
Top thrust washer, hardened, 32 OD	4.0	33.4
Preload nut, 7/16-20 heavy hex	10.7	44.1
Jam nut	6.4	50.5
Top thread: 5 free, 6 under the pad	10.9	61.4 (thread end)
Push pad, 8 mm (6 mm on the thread)	2.0 above the thread end	63.4

Spindle cap (now a clamped collar; the washers sit on top of it)

Feature	Dimension
Material	4140 pre-hardened
Spline bore	22.0 mm, slip fit on the 21.9 mm crests
Clamp skirt	58 mm below the spindle end face, leaving 6 mm clear of the pulley
Clamp	Two-piece, 3 × M8 12.9 per side at 32 Nm (see Spindle collar detail)
Shoulder	6 mm thick; 12.05 mm hole, a close fit on the drawbar's 12.0 centring land so it centres the drawbar in the 13.1 mm spindle bore
Washer seat	Top face of the shoulder, 32 mm diameter, flat and smooth
OD	52 mm
Hook flange	64 mm OD × 6 mm, level with the shoulder
Overall height	64 mm (6 shoulder + 58 skirt)
Shroud	Optional light sleeve to keep chips and coolant off the stack; not load-bearing

Drawbar

Feature	Dimension
Material	4140/709M pre-hardened as supplied (Atlas quotes 269–331 HB; check Edcon's certificate), turned from 16 mm bar
Lower thread	M12 × 1.75; length = collet thread depth + 3 mm (row 3.7, pending)
Body	11.0 mm (down from the old 11.5); it passes the collar's 12.05 centring hole and runs in the 13.1 mm spindle bore
Guide section	12.0 mm centring land in the cap shoulder, then 11.2 mm through the washer stack, about 0.2 mm clearance in the 11.4 mm washer

Feature	Dimension
	bore; harden if practical (DIN guidance for guide surfaces is at least 55 HRC)
Tip to spindle end face	About 250 mm, from the existing drawbar; confirm with the new collet (row 3.5)
Top thread	7/16-20 UNF, about 28 mm, for nut, jam nut and adjustment
Above spindle end face	About 61.4 mm to the thread end; push pad top at 63.4 mm
Overall length	About 311 mm
Push pad	Hardened, screwed on and thread-locked
Tension at preload	8.2 kN on about 84.3 mm² (M12 × 1.75 stress area), about 97 MPa

Set preload by stack height, not torque. Measure the free height of your washers first (viking45 measured 2.9 mm), then tighten the nut until the stack between the thrust washers is 8 × (free height − 0.35 mm): about 20.4 mm. Lock it with the jam nut. As a cross-check, that is about 2.8 mm of compression, about 2.2 turns of the 7/16-20 thread past hand-tight, close to Tormach's "hand tight plus two turns". The M12 collet thread (7 Nov 2026) doesn't change any of this: the preload is set by the washer stack's compression, not by either thread, so it stays 8.2 kN. The top thread stays 7/16-20 because the washers (11.4 bore) slide on over it, and an M12 top thread would not pass through them. At 8.2 kN the M12 lower thread runs at about 97 MPa on its 84.3 mm² stress area. Re-check after two weeks: a stack loses about 5% of its force in the first two weeks (Surisa).

Spindle collar detail

A two-piece clamp collar with a 58 mm skirt and 3 × M8 12.9 per side is estimated to hold about 14 kN axially. With the regulator at 5.0 bar and the 6:1 wedge, the worst case of a stuck collet loads it to about 5.4 kN, a margin of about 2.6. The holding figure is an estimate, so a witness line still checks it in service, and a positive groove is the fallback if the spindle can be machined.

Worst-case load (stuck collet)

If the collet sticks in the taper, the drawbar cannot move. The stack stays at its 8.2 kN preload while the cylinder pushes the drawbar down and the yoke pulls the collar up. The collar clamp carries the difference until the button is released.

Regulator setting	Drawbar force, 80 mm at 6:1 (kN)	Collar load (kN)
6.2 bar (full supply)	16.8	8.6
5.5 bar	14.9	6.7
5.0 bar (setting)	13.6	5.4

Normal duty is only P, the push-out force of a released R8 collet, which should be well under 1 kN because the 16°51′ taper is not self-locking. 5.0 bar is still about 0.5 bar above the expected 4.5 bar release pressure (8 washers, 1.2 mm stroke).

Clamp options compared (my estimates)

Axial holding ≈ 0.25 × 2π × μ × T, where T is the screw tension across one cut, μ = 0.15 dry steel, and 0.25 is a conservative allowance for a stiff ring gripping spline crests only. In this thin-ring model, holding rises with screw tension per cut, not with the number of cuts or the contact length. Screw tension uses T ≈ 0.2 × F × d.

Option	Screws	Tension per cut (kN)	Holding (kN)	Margin at 5.0 bar	OD (mm)
One-piece, 25 mm skirt (previous)	2 × M6 at 16 Nm	26	about 6	1.1	42
Two-piece, 40 mm skirt	3 × M6 per side at 16 Nm	40	about 9.4	1.7	44
Two-piece, 58 mm skirt (recommended)	**3 × M8 per side at 32 Nm**	**60**	**about 14**	**2.6**	**52**

The two-piece form also clamps more evenly than a single-slit ring, is self-balancing, and its centring hole stays put when the screws are tightened. M8 12.9 at 32 Nm is about 20 kN per screw, roughly 56% of its proof load of about 35 kN (from memory).

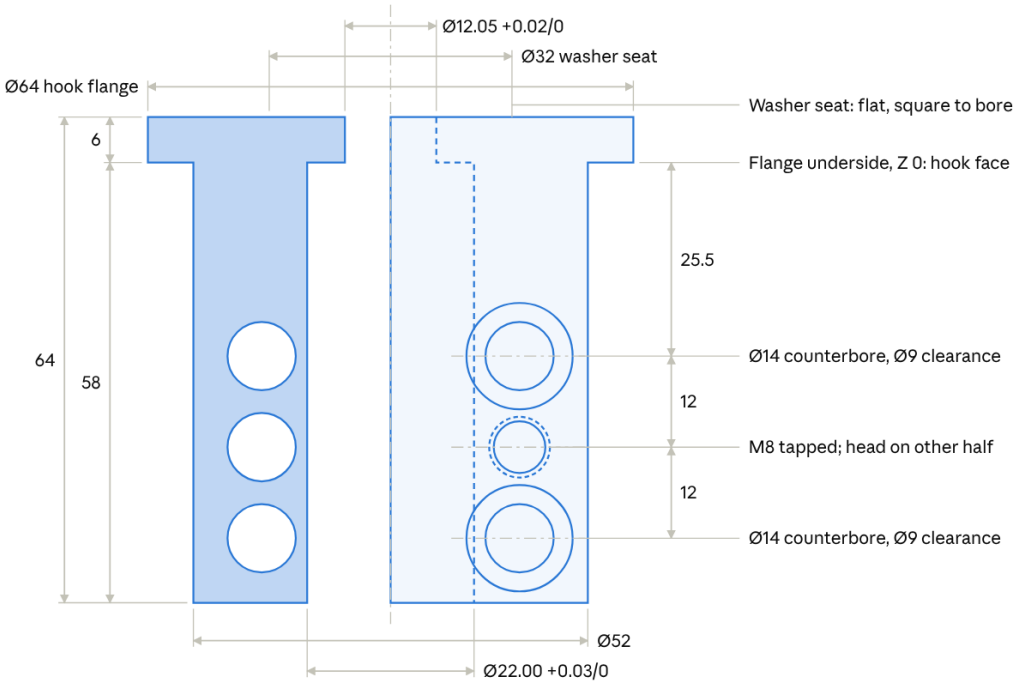
Recommended collar

Feature	Dimension and notes
Type	Two-piece clamp collar, split on a diameter through skirt, shoulder and flange
Material	4140/709M pre-hardened as supplied (Atlas quotes 269–331 HB; check Edcon's certificate)
Spline bore	22.0 mm, finished with the halves shimmed apart (below) so they close onto the 21.9 mm crests
Shoulder	6 mm thick; underside flat and square to the bore, seats on the spindle end face
Centring hole	12.05 +0.02/0 mm through the shoulder, close fit on the drawbar's 12.0 centring land; the M12 thread (11.97 maximum major diameter) passes through it
Washer seat	Top face of the shoulder, 32 mm diameter, flat, smooth and square to the bore
Clamp skirt	58 mm below the shoulder; leaves 6 mm clear of the pulley (64 mm stick-up). Lengthened from 40 mm, then from 54 to 58 mm on 7 Nov 2026 when the screw rows moved down to clear the 16 mm fork plate
OD	52 mm
Clamp screws	3 × M8 × 25 socket head, grade 12.9, per side, on axes 17 mm from the bore axis, at 25.5, 37.5 and 49.5 mm below the shoulder (moved down 5.5 mm on 7 Nov 2026: at 20 mm the top-row heads, Z −13.5 to −26.5 and out to about R31, reached 3.5 mm into the path of the 16 mm fork plate, Z −17 to −1 inside R27; they now clear it by 2 mm); heads on alternate halves row by row. The heads stand out to about Ø60, inside the Ø64 flange; 32 Nm, tightened evenly so both joint gaps stay equal

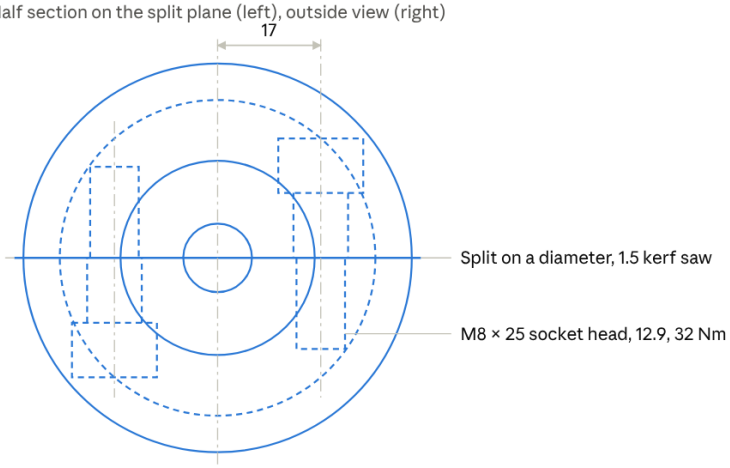
Feature	Dimension and notes
Hook flange	64 mm OD × 6 mm, level with the shoulder; underside flat, carries the yoke hook
Clamp surfaces	Bore as turned, not polished; degrease bore and spline crests before fitting, and keep the MoS_2 from the washer stack off them
Mass	About 0.9 kg (calculated)

Spindle collar: two-piece 4140 clamp, Ø52 × 64 overall

Dimensions in mm. Z 0 is the shoulder underside, which seats on the spindle end face.



Half section on the split plane (left), outside view (right)



Plan from above; screws hidden, heads alternate by row

4140/709M as supplied (Atlas quotes 269–331 HB). Tolerances ISO 2768-m unless stated; break sharp edges 0.2.
Turn the blank, roughing the bores 1 mm under; drill, tap and counterbore; split; reassemble on 0.2 shims.
Then finish the Ø22.00 bore, Ø12.05 hole, shoulder underside and washer seat in one setting.
Seat and underside flat and square to the bore within 0.01 (my judgement). Remove the shims before fitting.
Heads stand proud of Ø52 but stay inside Ø64, 2 below the 16 mm fork plate (top row at Z −25.5; rows moved 7 Nov 2026).
Counterbore floor about 10.7 from the joint face; tap M8 × 1.25 at least 15 deep. Mass about 0.9 kg (calculated).

collar machining drawing · half section, outside view, plan

Making it

1. Turn the blank: OD, flange, and rough bores about 1 mm undersize.
2. Drill and tap the six M8 holes and counterbore the heads, then split on the diameter with a slitting saw (about 1.5 mm kerf).
3. Reassemble the halves with 0.2 mm shims in both joints and torque the screws.
4. In one setting, finish-bore 22.0 mm and the 12.05 mm centring hole, and face the shoulder underside and washer seat.
5. Remove the shims for fitting, so each joint can close 0.2 mm onto the spline.

Checks and fallback

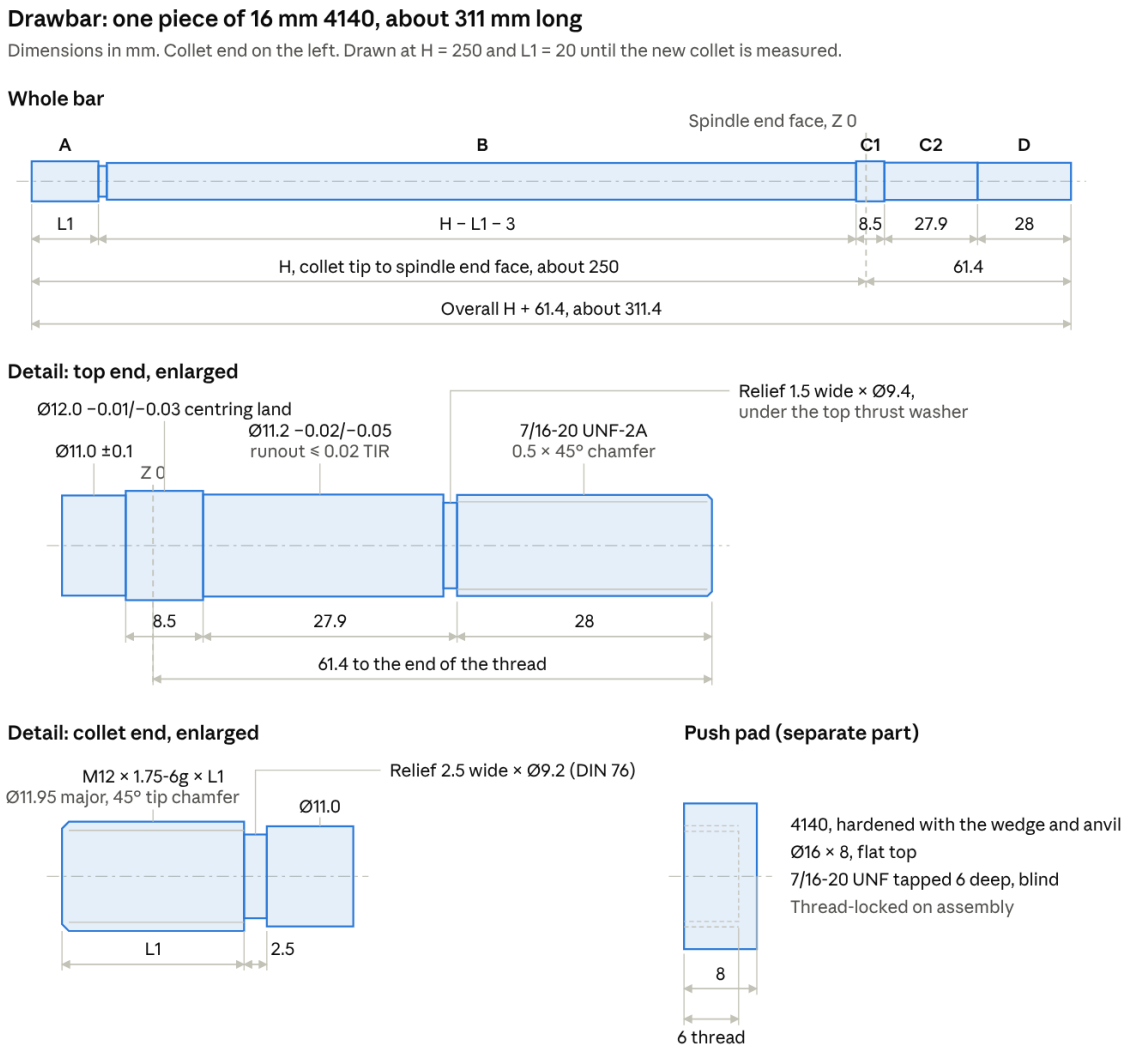
- Scribe a witness line across collar and spindle; check it at commissioning, after any stuck-collet event, and monthly.
- Release the button at once if the tool does not drop; holding the button on a stuck collet is the only way to load the collar this hard.
- Fallback if the collar ever moves: if the spline is soft enough to file, cut a 1 mm deep groove across the crests about 15 mm below the end face (spindle out, in the lathe), and add a matching internal rib to the collar halves. That makes the axial hold positive instead of frictional.

Drawbar detail

The drawbar is four turned sections from one piece of 16 mm 4140 bar, about 311 mm long with the 8-washer stack. Two lengths stay open until the new collet arrives: L1, the lower thread length, and H, the tip-to-spindle-face length.

Section, from the collet end	Diameter	Length	Notes
A. Lower thread	M12 × 1.75-6g, major diameter held at about 11.95	L1 = collet thread depth + 3 mm (row 3.7, pending)	45° chamfer on the tip; 1.5 mm thread relief at the runout
B. Body	11.0 ±0.1 mm	H − L1 − 3 mm (about 225 mm; H about 250 mm, row 3.5, pending)	Under the collar's 12.05 centring hole (as is the M12 thread), so the bar and stack lift out with the collar still clamped; runs in the 13.1 mm spindle bore
C1. Centring land	12.0 −0.01/−0.03 mm	From 3 mm below the spindle end face to 5.5 mm above it: 8.5 mm	Added 7 Nov 2026 for the M12 collet thread: a close fit in the collar's 12.05 centring hole, so the drawbar is still centred in the 13.1 spindle bore. It stops 0.5 below the shoulder top, so the base thrust washer seats on the collar, not on the step
C2. Guide	11.2 −0.02/−0.05 mm	From 5.5 to 33.4 mm above the spindle end face: about 28 mm	Fine-turned or ground; nitride or harden if practical. Runs through the thrust washers and the washer bores (about 0.2 mm clearance in the 11.4 mm washer bore)
D. Top thread	7/16-20 UNF-2A	28 mm	Preload nut, jam nut, about 5 mm adjustment, push pad

Section, from the collet end	Diameter	Length	Notes
Push pad	16 mm × 8 mm	6 mm on the thread, top about 63.4 mm above the spindle end face	4140 from the Ø16 drawbar offcut, hardened with the wedge and anvil; tapped 7/16-20 blind; flat top; thread-locked



drawbar machining drawing · whole bar, top-end and collet-end details, push pad

Manufacturing notes

- Turn between centres so the guide section and both threads stay concentric; aim for 0.02 mm runout or better on the guide (my judgement).
- Single-point the lower thread to M12 × 1.75-6g with the major diameter at about 11.95, so it passes the collar's 12.05 hole, and check it in the new collet. Single-point the top thread to 7/16-20 UNF-2A and check it with the preload nut. Do both before parting off.
- Put a small undercut at each diameter step rather than a sharp corner; the body-to-guide step sits in the spindle bore, not under load.

- Overall length = H + 33.4 + 28 mm, about 311 mm for H = 250 mm and 8 washers.

Wedge actuator

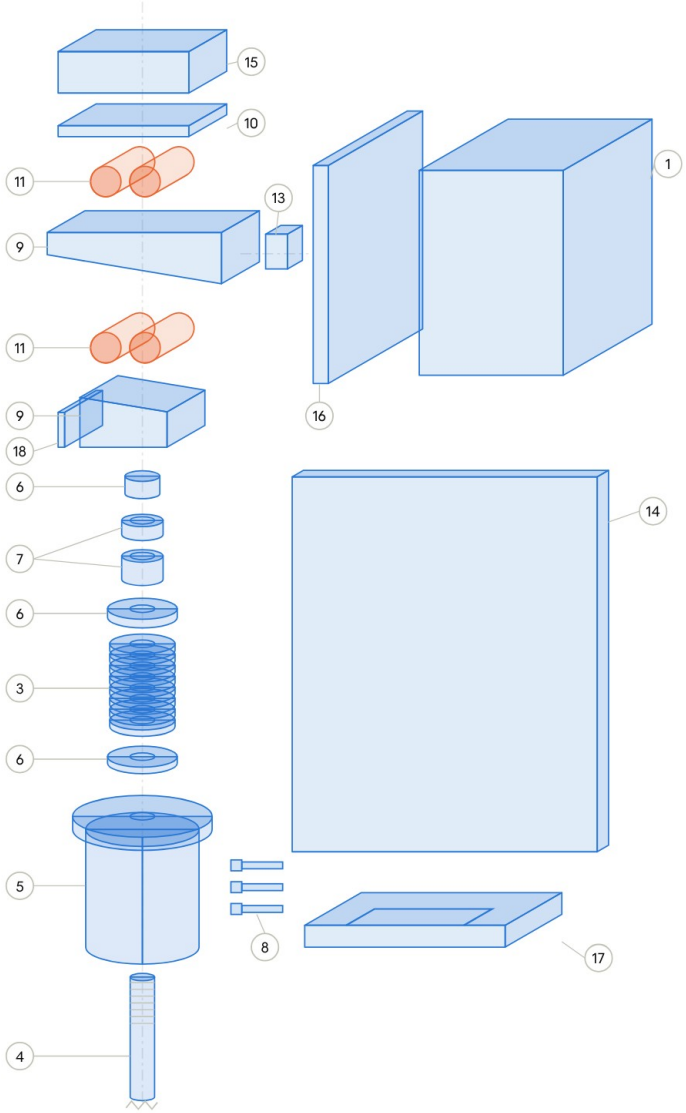
A 9.5° wedge between caged rollers gives 6:1 in a housing whose top is about Z 152, about 4.9 kg with the cylinder (my estimate). The price is precision work: a hardened, ground wedge, anvil and wear plate. The side view under Concept layout shows it assembled; the exploded view below shows every part.

How it works. The cylinder lies horizontal in front of the spindle and pushes a wedge rearward between two pairs of rollers. The upper rollers run under a hardened roof plate; the lower rollers run on the anvil, whose top is cut at the same 9.5° so the faces stay parallel. As the wedge advances, the anvil is driven down onto the push pad. The roof's reaction goes up through the housing side plates to the fork under the collar flange: the closed force loop described under Force path. The cylinder mount reacts the wedge's horizontal load, and a rear thrust bar reacts the anvil's (about 2.8 kN, pushing the anvil rearward).

Orientation (decided 28 Oct 2026). The cylinder faces forward, sitting in front of the spindle above the head, and the wedge travels toward the rear. That keeps the space behind the spindle, over the motor pulley, clear for a possible motor-shaft encoder later. The four belt-cover posts come off and the housing base takes the belt cover's place. The drawings are unchanged: the side view is seen from the machine's left, so the front is to the right. Ports face the machine's left (decided 29 Oct 2026), toward the viewer in the side view. Ports up would put the PC10-03 fittings above the housing top (port face about Z 149 against a top at about Z 152), and ports down would foul the wedge and roof block.

Wedge design, exploded: everything stacks on the drawbar axis

Oblique view, about 1.6 px per mm. Balloon numbers are List B rows. The cylinder train (front of machine) explodes to the right.



Key (List B row numbers)

1 Air cylinder, SDA 80 × 25
3 Belleville washers, 8 × Tormach 31319
4 Drawbar (top end shown)
5 Spindle collar, two-piece
6 Push pad; top and base thrust washers
7 Jam nut and preload nut
8 Collar clamp screws, 6 × M8 × 25 (3 shown)
9 Wedge (upper) and anvil (lower), 4140
10 Roof wear plate, O1
11 Rollers, Ø14 × 36 dowel pins, 2 per face, 18 mm pitch
12 Roller cages (not drawn)
13 Floating joint, SMC JA40-14-150
14 Housing side plates (one shown)
15 Roof block
16 Cylinder mount plate
17 Fork plate; U-slot fits under the collar flange
18 Bronze strip on the rear thrust bar (bar not drawn)
19 Hard stop, in the housing (not drawn)

Parts go on bottom to top in the order shown; the side plates and fork close the box around the stack.

wedge design · exploded view, balloons match List B

Design

Feature	Value	Notes
Wedge angle	9.5° on the underside, top flat	tan 9.5° ≈ 1/6, so 6:1
Wedge travel	13 mm for a 1.2 mm stroke + 1 mm gap	The 25 mm cylinder stroke is not the limit; 8 washers go flat at

Feature	Value	Notes
		about 2 mm
Wedge	4140 (from Ø50 round bar or 25 mm plate), about 80 × 40 mm; 10 mm thick at the leading end, 23.5 mm at the trailing end	Through-hardened to about 50 HRC; top and underside ground
Rollers	4 × Ø14 × 36 mm hardened ground dowel pins (ISO 8734), 2 per face at 18 mm pitch, in two 2 mm brass cages with light centring springs (drawing below)	Free rollers between parallel faces: no axles or bearings to overload
Roof	O1 wear plate 60 × 40 × 5 mm, hardened and ground, under a 19 mm 6061-T6 roof block	
Anvil	4140, 40 × 40 mm, 16.0–22.7 mm tall with the 9.5° top; bottom flat on the push pad; through-hardened to about 50 HRC and ground	The 9.5° faces push the anvil the way the wedge travels (rearward), so its rear face bears on a bronze-faced rear thrust bar; two sprung Ø5 lift pins hold it 1 mm up at rest
Housing	Two 12 mm 6060 side plates 130 × 189, 42 mm apart inside (set by the roof block), each with a window for the fork plate and a notch round the collar; roof block, cylinder mount plate	The side plates also carry the fork plate and the float lugs
Cylinder	SDA 80 × 25, horizontal with its axis at Z 102, level with the wedge's M14 hole, front face bolted to the mount plate with M12 screws into its front threads, or M10 through-bolts the full length of the body	Pushes on the full bore; M14 × 1.5 floating joint (SMC JA40-14-150) between the rod and the wedge (List B row 13)
Hard stop	Screw in the housing at the wedge's leading end	Sets maximum travel
Height	About Z 152	The lever alternative (Appendix B) reaches about Z 275

Load check (my calculations; full 6.2 bar supply, 5.0 bar setting in brackets)

Item	Load	Section	Stress	Verdict
Roller line contact	16.8 (13.6) kN per face, 2 rollers	Ø14 × 36 mm each	about 1,110 (1,000) MPa Hertz peak	OK in hardened 4140 in every case, including one roller taking the whole load (see the material note below)
Anvil on push pad	16.8 kN	Flat on the 16 mm pad, 201 mm²	84 MPa	Far easier than the lever's line contact
Anvil horizontal thrust	2.8 (2.3) kN	Bronze wear strip	Low	Friction about 0.3 kN, within the 0.9 efficiency
Roof block	168 N·m over a 40 mm span	19 × 60 mm 6061-T6	47 MPa (6061-T6 yields at	OK

Item	Load	Section	Stress	Verdict
			about 240)	
Side plates	16.8 kN tension, shared	2 × 12 × 80 mm 6061	9 MPa	OK
Cylinder mount	3.1 kN	4 screws in the front face	Low	OK
Fork plate tines	16.8 kN, 8.4 kN per tine	19 × 16 mm mild steel, 54 mm span between the feet	96 MPa bending	OK; 10 mm thick would be about 168 MPa
Flange on the fork	16.8 kN	About 230 mm² where the tines overlap the flange	About 73 MPa	OK
Side-plate feet	4.2 kN per foot	12 × 20 mm 6061, 20 mm cantilever	About 53 MPa	OK: a factor of about 2.3 on 6060-T5's 120 MPa minimum proof stress (EN 755-2)

The wedge back-drives: 9.5° is steeper than the friction angle even for sliding steel (about 5.7°), so it can't jam, and the cylinder pulls it back on retract.

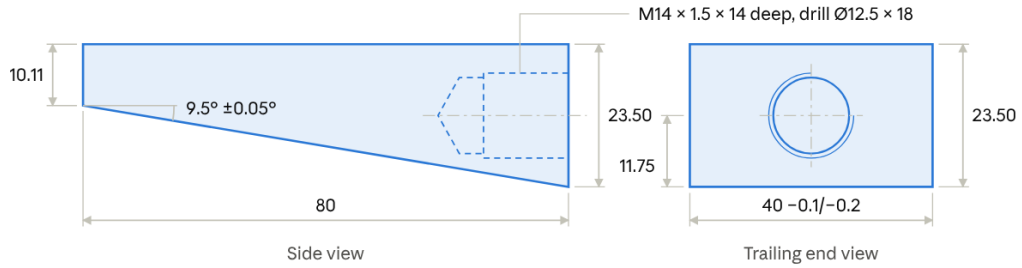
Points to watch

- **Load sharing.** Grind the wedge, anvil and roof faces flat and parallel to about 0.01 mm (my judgement), across the 40 mm width as well as along the length. If one roller of a pair carries everything, its contact stress rises to about 1,560 MPa.
- **Cage creep.** Free rollers travel at half the wedge speed and can walk over many cycles. Centre the cage with two light springs and check it after run-in.
- **Grinding.** The wedge, anvil and roof plate need a surface grinder after hardening, or can be sent out.
- **Ratio.** It is fixed by the wedge angle. Changing it means a new wedge and anvil, whereas the lever's slotted pivot adjusts from 5:1 to 6:1.

Wedge and anvil: 4140, hardened and ground as a matched pair

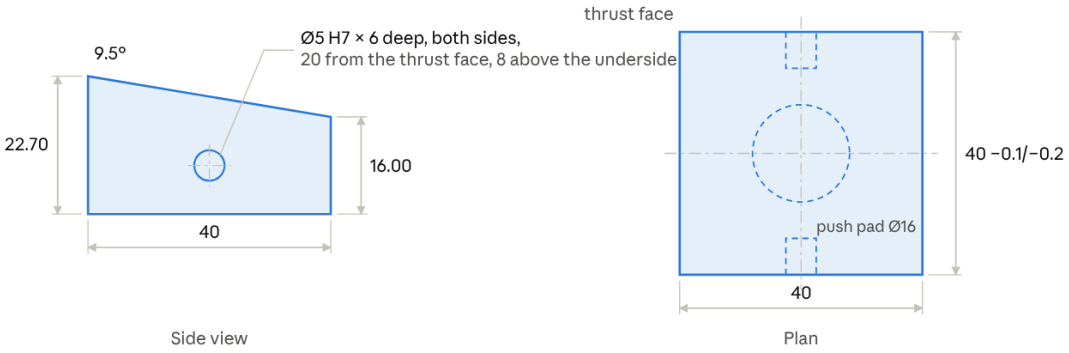
Dimensions in mm, about 4 px per mm. The wedge travels to the left in the side views (toward the rear of the machine).

Wedge



4140: oil-harden from 850–860 °C, temper 200 °C (about 50 HRC). Grind top, 9.5° underside, sides; flat to 0.005.
Tap M14 × 1.5 before hardening; the JA nut bears on the end face. Wall to the slope is 2.4 min at the hole bottom.
Leading end 10.11 thick (23.50 − 80 × tan 9.5°); break all edges 0.3.

Anvil



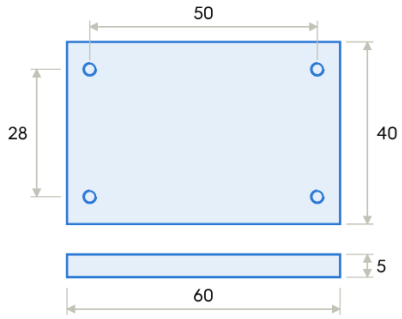
4140, about 50 HRC. Grind underside, 9.5° top (same setting as the wedge) and thrust face, flat to 0.005.
Ream Ø5 H7 before hardening; press in two Ø5 m6 × 10 dowels (ISO 8734) afterwards, 4 proud each side.
The thrust face (leading side) bears on the rear thrust bar's bronze strip; the push pad bears on the centre of the underside.

wedge and anvil machining drawing

Roof block, wear plate and roller cages

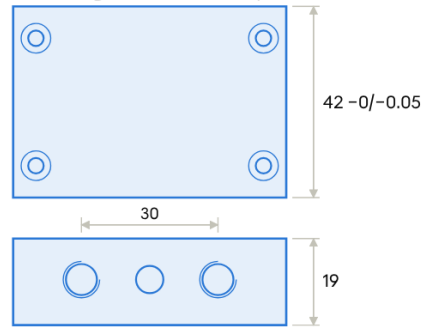
Dimensions in mm, about 3 px per mm. Plans look down; the wedge travels to the left.

Roof wear plate (O1)



Roof block (6061-T6)

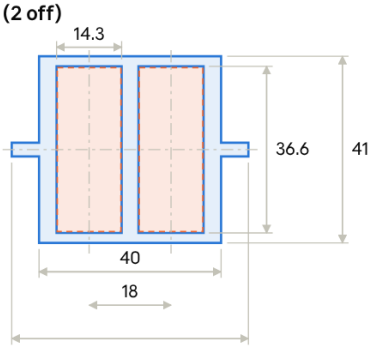
Plan, 60 long; holes as the wear plate



End view (each side face)

Wear plate: O1 from 40 × 5 stock, 58–62 HRC, faces parallel within 0.005; the rolling face is unbroken.
4 × M3 from the top, before hardening: drill Ø2.5 × 3.2 flat-bottomed, tap 3 deep (1.8 skin left).
Roof block: 6061-T6, 19 thick, 42 wide (sets the side-plate spacing); 4 × Ø3.4 c'bored Ø6.5 × 3.5 for M3 × 18.
Each end face: 2 × M8, 14 deep, at 30 centres, 9 from the top, and 1 × Ø6 H7 dowel hole, 10 deep, to the side plates.

Roller cage (2 off)



52 over the tongues (tongues 3 wide)

Brass sheet, 2 mm; 2 off (upper and lower).
Windows 14.3 × 36.6 at 18 mm pitch hold
the Ø14 × 36 rollers (dashed) with 0.3 / 0.6 play.
Sits on the roller centre plane, 6 mm clear of each face.
Each tongue carries a light spring (Ø5 × 16 free,
about 0.1 N/mm) bearing on a Ø5 cross pin at X ±40.
Upper cage runs level; the lower one is parallel to the anvil.

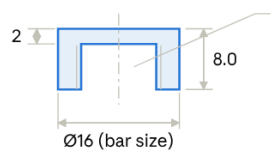
Break all edges in the windows so they cannot score the rollers.

roof block, wear plate and roller cage drawing

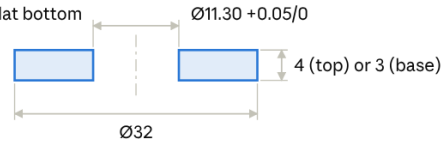
Small parts: push pad, thrust washers, rear thrust bar, stop block, mount plate

Dimensions in mm. Pad and washers about 5 px per mm (sections), bar and block 3, mount plate 2.

Push pad (1 off)



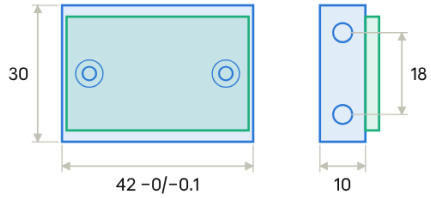
Thrust washers (2 off, 3 and 4 thick)



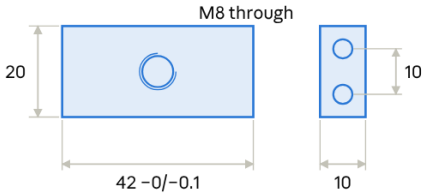
Push pad: Ø16 4140 drawbar offcut, faced to 8.0. Drill 9.9 (25/64″), flat-bottom to 6.0, then a bottoming tap. The drawbar end bears on the flat bottom; top flat and square to the thread within 0.02.

Washers: 4140 from the Ø50 bar; bore 11.30 +0.05/0 on the 11.2 guide; faces flat and parallel within 0.01. Harden all three with the wedge and anvil (4140, about 50 HRC); lap the washer faces after hardening; break edges 0.2.

Rear thrust bar (1 off)



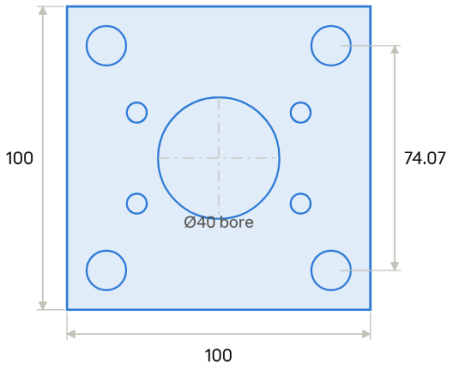
Rear stop block (1 off)



Thrust bar: 6061-T6, 42 −0/−0.1 long to fit between the side plates; each end 2 × M5, 12 deep, at 18 centres. Bronze strip 3 × 25 × 40 on the anvil face: 2 × M3 countersunk at 30 centres, heads 0.3 below the bronze face. The bar sits at Z 60 to 90 (screws at Z 66 and 84), so the strip covers the anvil's thrust face over about Z 62 to 87.

Stop block: 6061-T6, 42 −0/−0.1 long; M8 tapped through on centre, square to the face within 0.05; each end 2 × M5, 12 deep, at 10 centres. M8 × 30 set screw and lock nut; the tip meets the wedge's leading end at its mid-height.

Cylinder mount plate (1 off)



12 mm 6061-T6, 100 × 100, centred on the cylinder axis (Z 102). 4 × Ø13 on a 74.07 square for M12 × 35 socket heads: 14 mm plain, then 9 of the 14 mm thread engaged.

Centre bore Ø40 clears the rod, boss and JA joint. 4 × Ø6.6 at ±27 across, ±15 from the axis, for M6 × 25 into the side plates' front edges (Z 87 and 117).

If the JA joint needs more room, fit spacer tubes on the M12 screws; their length is set once it is measured.

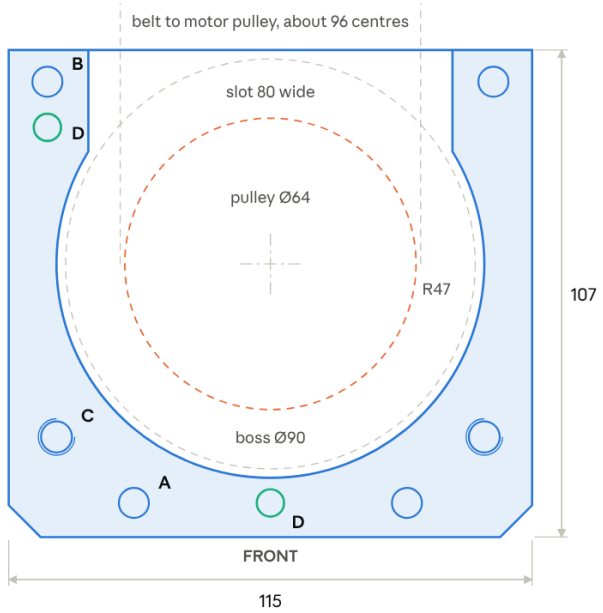
small parts drawing · push pad, thrust washers, rear thrust bar, stop block, cylinder mount plate

The push pad comes from the Ø16 4140 drawbar offcut and the thrust washers from the Ø50 4140 bar; all three are hardened with the wedge and anvil (decided 29 Oct 2026: no Ø35 silver steel needed). The mount plate's Ø40 bore clears the rod, its boss and the JA joint.

Base plate and float guides: the housing rides on two pins on the head top

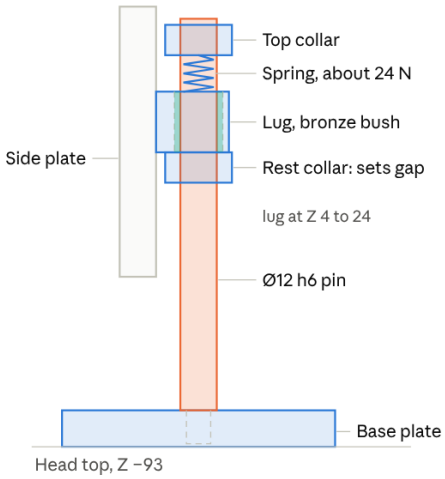
Dimensions in mm from the spindle axis. The head top is flat (9.10); bed the plate on bare metal.

Base plate, plan (3 px/mm, front at the bottom)



Float guide (2 off)

Seen from the front, about 2 px per mm



Base plate: 12 mm 6061-T6, outline flush with the head top, front corners chamfered 7 to match the casting.
Cut-out R47 about the spindle axis, opening into an 80 wide slot to the rear; the belt runs straight at about ±33.

Holes, (left/right, forward +) from the spindle axis:

A 2 × Ø6.6 for M6 × 20 at (±30, +52.5) · B 2 × Ø6.6 for M6 × 20 at (±49, −40)
C 2 × M8 for the guide pins at (±47, +38) · D 2 × Ø6 H7 dowels at (0, +52.5) and (−49, −30)

Spot A and B through the plate onto the head top, drill Ø5.0 through the 9 mm casting and tap M6.
Ream D with the plate centred on the spindle (a turned plug in the spindle bore, or indicate the boss).
Guide pins: Ø12 h6 ground rod 140 long, M8 × 11 spigot, Loctite into C. Collars set the fork gap at 0.5–1 mm.

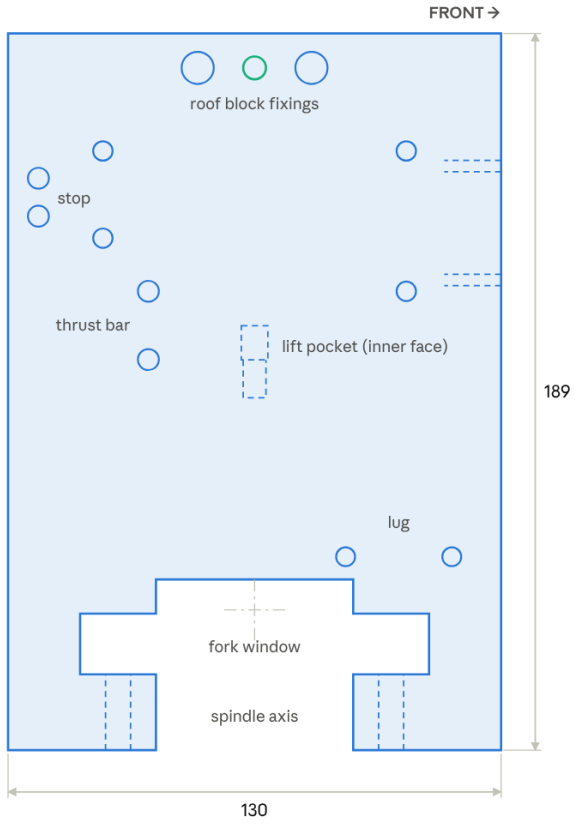
base plate and float guides · plan of the head-top plate, one guide in elevation

The housing rests on two Ø12 guide pins standing on a base plate that replaces the belt cover. The rest collars set the fork-to-flange gap; the springs above the lugs (about 24 N each, roughly half the housing weight) keep it down during Z moves. Those springs push on the spindle only during release, when the housing lifts the gap off the collars.

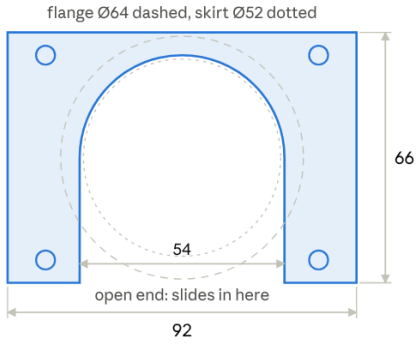
Side plates and fork plate: the fork rests on the plates' feet, so no screw carries the release load

Side plate seen from the machine's left, front to the right, 2.5 px per mm. X from the spindle axis (front +), Z from the spindle end face.

Side plate (2 off, mirrored pair)



Fork plate (1 off), plan



Mild steel, 16 thick, 92 × 66.
Slot 54 wide, closed end R27 on the axis.
4 × M6 tapped at (±36, ±27), screwed up through the plates' feet.
Top face flat; break the slot edges 0.5.

Worst case 16.8 kN (my calculation): tine bending 96 MPa, flange contact about 73 MPa, aluminium foot 53 MPa.

12 mm 6061-T6. Window 92 × 16.2 (Z −17 to −0.8) takes the fork; notch 52 wide up to Z 8 clears the collar and its screws. Inside corners R2.

Roof block: 2 × Ø8.5 at (±15, 142.9) for M8; Ø6 H7 dowel at (0, 142.9). Cage cross pins Ø5.1 through: (±40, 121), (−40, 98), (+40, 84).
Thrust bar: 2 × Ø5.5 at (−28, 66) and (−28, 84). Stop block: 2 × Ø5.5 at (−57, 103.8) and (−57, 113.8). Both for M5.
Float lug: 2 × M6 tapped through at (24, 14) and (52, 14). Front edge: 2 × M6 × 15 deep at Z 87 and 117, mid-thickness.
Inner face: anvil lift pocket at X 0, 7 wide × 9 tall (Z 65.9 to 74.9) × 3.5 deep, with a Ø6 × 10 spring pocket below it.
Feet: Ø6.6 up through each foot at X ±36, mid-thickness, for the M6 × 30 screws that hold the fork down.

Holes are listed as (X, Z). Make the plates as a mirrored pair so both pockets face inward.

side plates and fork plate · elevation of one plate with all holes, fork plate plan

The fork slides in sideways through a window in both side plates and sits on the plates' feet, so the release reaction goes into the aluminium in bearing rather than through screws in tension. A notch up the middle of each plate clears the collar and its clamp screws. The fork is 16 mm thick, not the 10 mm first listed: at 10 mm the tines would have reached about 168 MPa in bending at the worst-case 16.8 kN, too close to mild steel's yield.

Housing details fixed by these parts.

- **Cylinder axis at Z 102**, level with the wedge's M14 hole. That brings the housing top down to about Z 152.
- **Rear thrust bar** between the side plates (6061-T6 10 × 30 × 42, faced with the bronze strip) takes the anvil's 2.8 kN horizontal load. The 9.5° faces push the anvil the way the wedge travels (rearward), so the bar sits behind the anvil.
- **Anvil lift:** two Ø5 m6 × 10 dowel pins (ISO 8734) pressed into the anvil's sides (silver steel is ground under nominal, so it would be loose in an H7 hole) run in slots 7 wide × 9 tall in the side plates. A light spring in a Ø6 pocket under each pin holds the anvil 1 mm clear of the push pad at rest.

- **Cage springs** bear on four Ø5 silver-steel cross pins through the side plates at X ±40: Z about 121 for the upper cage, and about 98 (rear) and 84 (front) for the lower cage. Each cage moves half the wedge travel, 7.5 mm at the hard stop, so the springs stay well short of solid.
- **Roof block** is 42 wide and sets the side-plate spacing; each side fixes with 2 × M8 and a Ø6 dowel.
- **Head mounting (decided 29 Oct 2026):** a 12 mm 6060 base plate takes the belt cover's place on the flat head top (Z −93, measured: boss 5 + pulley clearance 24 + spindle 64 above the pulley). It is fixed with 4 × M6 × 20 into new holes tapped through the 9 mm casting top (1.5 × d engagement in iron), and located by 2 × Ø6 dowels reamed with the plate centred on the spindle. The screws only carry the housing's weight (about 4.9 kg, roughly 48 N) plus Z-move inertia, because the release force stays in the closed loop. The rear slot clears the belt: with equal Ø64 pulleys at about 96 centres the belt runs straight at about ±33 from the axis, and the arms stop 45 behind the axis, well ahead of the motor pulley (front edge about 64 behind, more once the belt is tensioned). The whole head top is flat (sheet 9.10). Scrape the paint off under the plate's footprint so it beds on bare iron, which keeps the guide pins square to the head. The existing M4 corner holes are not used. Do not use the four M4 holes in the 90 mm boss: they hold the spindle's top bearing cap, and their original cap screws should go back in once the old sensor's aluminium standoffs come out.
- **Mass (updated 29 Oct 2026, my estimate from part volumes):** the mount plate, base plate, roof block, lugs, thrust bar and stop block are 6061-T6; the fork stays steel because it bears on the hardened collar flange. The floating housing is about 4.9 kg: side plates 1.40, cylinder 1.20, wedge and anvil 0.66, fork 0.40, mount plate 0.28, roof block and wear plate 0.22, JA joint and stud 0.21, rollers 0.17, lugs 0.10, and about 0.3 for the thrust bar, stop block, cages and screws. The base plate, guide pins and collars fixed to the head add about 0.5 kg, and the collar, washers and push pad on the spindle about 0.95 kg. That is about 6.4 kg, roughly 63 N, added to the head, less the belt cover and posts that come off. A Z-axis gas strut needs about 63 N more lift than the head needs today.
- **Z-axis gas strut (sizing; brackets still to design):** it should carry most of the head's weight so the Z stepper is not holding it all, but never lift the head on its own if the Z drive loses power. The drawbar adds about 63 N to what it must carry.
    - **Stroke:** the SX2.3 manual gives 240 mm of headstock travel, so the strut needs at least 250 mm of stroke (check your CNC soft limits). A gas spring is typically about twice its stroke plus 50–80 mm of end fittings long when extended (my recollection; use the maker's table), so expect about 560–600 mm extended and 310–350 mm compressed, between a bracket at the column top and one on the head.
    - **Force:** a gas spring pushes harder as it compresses, typically 1.2–1.4 times its extended force over the stroke (from memory). Mount it so it is longest with the head at the bottom, and choose the extended rating at about 0.7 × the total head weight W. With about 1.3 progression it then balances roughly 70–90% of W over the travel, and the head always tends to settle down.
    - **Measuring W:** with the Z motor coupling undone, hang the head from a luggage scale and read the force just as it starts to rise and just as it starts to fall. The average cancels the slide friction. Do it with the drawbar housing fitted, or add 63 N.
    - **Buying:** order a gas spring with a bleed valve, charged a little above the estimate, then bleed it down on the machine until the head just settles under its own weight at the top of its travel. Mount it rod-down where the brackets allow; that is the usual makers' advice for seal life (from memory).
- **Rear stop block** (6061-T6 10 × 20 × 42) carries the M8 hard-stop screw against the wedge's leading end, set for 15 mm of wedge travel (1.5 mm at the drawbar).
- **Floating joint:** the rod is female M14 × 1.5 (re-measured 29 Oct 2026; first recorded as M12 × 1.75). An M14 × 1.5 stud goes into the rod, the joint's female socket screws onto it, and the joint's male M14 × 1.5 stud screws into the wedge. Part: SMC JA40-14-150, a standard catalogue item rated at 4,400 N maximum tension/compression, 0.75 mm eccentricity and ±5°, 0.16 kg (SMC JA catalogue). That is 1.4

× the worst-case cylinder thrust of 3.1 kN at an unregulated 6.2 bar, and 1.75 × the 2.51 kN at 5.0 bar. Its overall length (about 60 mm from the catalogue table; I couldn't confirm which dimension that is) must be checked against the rod-to-wedge gap before the cylinder mount plate is drawn. Installation per SMC: screw the socket on until it bottoms, back off 1–2 turns, then lock with thread adhesive.
Wedge hole: M14 × 1.5, thread 14 deep, 12.5 mm tap drill 18 deep, tapped before hardening. Correction to my earlier 20/26 mm depths: the 9.5° underside closes in on the hole as it goes deeper, and at those depths the wall to the slope would have been only about 1.2–1.4 mm. At 14/18 mm the minimum wall is about 2.4 mm, at the bottom of the hole, rising to 4.75 mm at the end face. Lock the JA stud's nut against the wedge end face, so the push goes through the face and the thread only carries the light retract load. Check that the stud can't bottom in the 14 mm thread; add a washer under the nut if it is longer.

Material choice (decided 29 Oct 2026). The wedge and anvil are 4140 rather than O1, because O1 in 40 × 25 section proved hard to source. The rollers only stress a thin surface layer: the contact strip is about 0.24–0.38 mm wide, with the peak shear about 0.10–0.15 mm below the surface. For a roller on a flat, first yield occurs at a peak contact pressure of about 1.79 × the yield strength (von Mises; Johnson, *Contact Mechanics*, 1985, quoted from memory). The three load cases therefore need a yield of about 560 MPa (1,000 MPa contact, 5.0 bar, rollers sharing), 620 MPa (1,110 MPa, 6.2 bar) and 880 MPa (1,574 MPa, one roller taking the load). Atlas lists 4140 bar up to Ø180 as supplied at 740 MPa minimum 0.2% proof (269–331 HB). That is enough when the rollers share, but short of 880 MPa in the one-roller case. Hardened at 850–860 °C, oil quenched and tempered at 175–230 °C, Atlas gives a yield above 1,380 MPa, about 1.6 × the worst case. A 25 mm section won't harden fully in the core, but only the surface layer carries the contact stress. Stock: the wedge section (40 × 23.5, 46.4 mm diagonal) and the anvil (40 × 22.7, 46.0 mm diagonal) both come out of Ø50 round bar, or from 25 mm plate. The wear plate stays O1 ground flat stock, which is easy to buy in thin sections.

Hardened parts: heat treatment and grinding. The wedge and anvil (4140) and the wear plate (O1) are rough-machined, hardened, tempered, then ground. The wedge and anvil slopes are ground on the same sine-bar setting so they match.

Step	Wedge and anvil (4140); wear plate (O1)	Notes
1. Rough machine	Saw and mill the wedge and anvil from Ø50 4140 round (or 25 mm plate) and the wear plate from O1 flat stock, leaving about 0.3 mm per face to grind (wedge and anvil slopes, top, underside and sides; both wear plate faces). Drill and tap the wedge's M14 × 1.5 and the wear plate's M3 holes, ream the anvil's Ø5 H7 holes, break all edges, mark each part	Grinding allowance is my judgement; it also removes any decarburised skin
2. Protect	Wrap in stainless heat-treat foil, or coat with anti-scale compound	Limits scale and decarburisation (common practice; not from the datasheets)
3. Preheat	4140: heat slowly, no separate preheat. O1: 650 °C, equalise	4140: Atlas datasheet ("heat slowly"). O1: Industeel 1.2510 datasheet; Hudson gives 649–704 °C, heating no faster than 222 °C/h

Step	Wedge and anvil (4140); wear plate (O1)	Notes
4. Harden	4140: 850–860 °C, hold until uniform. O1: 800–815 °C, 30 min after the part reaches temperature	4140: Atlas 850–860 °C. O1: Hudson 802–816 °C, 30 min per 25 mm; Industeel 780–820 °C
5. Quench	4140: quench vigorously in oil, agitating the part. O1: warm, agitated quench oil (about 55 °C); take the parts out while still hand-warm (above about 50 °C)	4140: Atlas (polymer quenchant also acceptable if equivalent). O1: Industeel and Hudson. Both can crack at sharp internal corners, so keep the radii
6. Temper	Immediately, while still warm. 4140: 200 °C for 2 h, air cool; never hold it between 230 and 370 °C. O1: 180–200 °C for 2 h, air cool, then a second temper	4140: Atlas gives 175–230 °C for ½–2 h for a yield above 1,380 MPa, and says to avoid 230–370 °C (blue brittleness); about 50 HRC is my estimate from typical tempering curves, not from Atlas. O1: Hudson 177–204 °C, 2 h minimum; Industeel calls for a double temper; as-quenched is about 64 HRC (Industeel) and 58–62 HRC after tempering is my reading of typical curves. Check both with a hardness tester or file
7. Grind references	Wedge top; anvil underside; both wear plate faces parallel within 0.005	These are the faces the slopes are measured from
8. Grind slopes	Reference face down on a sine bar set to 9.5°: gauge stack 16.505 mm on a 100 mm bar, or 0.8252″ on a 5″ bar. Grind the wedge underside, then, without changing the stack, the anvil top	sin 9.5° = 0.16505; ±0.05° is about ±0.09 mm on the 100 mm stack
9. Grind sides	Wedge and anvil to 40 −0.1/−0.2	1 mm side clearance to the side plates
10. Check the match	On a surface plate: anvil, two of your matched Ø14 pins, then the wedge. The wedge top must be parallel to the plate within 0.01 mm along and across. If it isn't, regrind the anvil slope	Tests the parts the way they will carry load

If you'd rather not quench at home, a commercial heat-treater can do steps 3–6: ask for the 4140 parts hardened and tempered at about 200 °C to at least 48 HRC, and the O1 wear plate at 58–62 HRC with a double temper.

Cutting list for the Edcon bars (ordered 29 Oct 2026). Saw lengths include facing allowance; allow about 2 mm per bandsaw cut. The Ø50 bar is 150 long, so take the washers off its end on the lathe first, then saw the wedge (82) and the anvil (42); about 8 mm is left over. Check the lengths you ordered against the minimum per bar.

Bar	Part	Finished size	Saw length (mm)	Minimum bar (mm)
4140 Ø16	Drawbar	about 311 long (H + 61.4; H to confirm with the new collet)	320	340, with the push pad
4140 Ø16	Push pad	Ø16 × 8	12	(from the same bar)
4140 Ø50	Wedge	80 × 40 × 23.5, bar axis along the 80	82	140 with the anvil and washers (you have 150)
4140 Ø50	Anvil	40 × 40 × 22.7, bar axis along one 40 side	42	(from the same bar)
4140 Ø50	2 thrust washers	Ø32 × 11.3 bore, 3 and 4 thick	14, turned off the bar end before sawing	(from the same bar; or the Ø65 collar offcut)
4140 Ø65	Collar	Ø64 flange, 64 high	70	70
W1 Ø5	4 cross pins	about 75 each, confirmed when the side plates are drawn	4 × 80	335 (you have 2 m)
O1 40 × 5	Wear plate	60 × 40 × 5	65	65 (you have 500)

Cutting the 150 mm Ø50 bar, in order.

Step	Operation	Uses (mm)	Bar left (mm)
1	Lathe: chuck the bar, face, turn 14 long to Ø32, drill and bore 11.30 +0.05/0, part off the 4.3 washer, face, part off the 3.3 washer	14	136
2	Saw the wedge blank	82 + 2 kerf	52
3	Saw the anvil blank	42 + 2 kerf	about 8 spare

Check each saw cut is square before facing: the wedge has 1 mm a side to face, and the anvil about 0.7 mm a side before its sides are milled to 40.6 and ground. If a cut goes wrong, make the washers from the Ø65 offcut left after the collar instead (that bar then needs to be at least 84 long), which frees the first 14 mm of the Ø50.

Cutting schedule for the aluminium (added 2 Nov 2026; plate parts changed to 12 × 160 flat bar 6 Nov 2026). Saw blade 3.5 mm wide (kerf). Blanks are about 1.5 mm a side oversize for milling to the finished outline. The 12 mm parts now come from 12 × 160 flat bar (purchased 6 Nov 2026) instead of a 400 × 250 plate, which couldn't be sourced. The blank sizes and cuts are my layout. The 12 × 160 bar is 6060 (confirmed 7 Nov 2026; temper to confirm, T5 assumed). EN 755-2 gives 6060-T5 extrusions a minimum proof stress of 120 MPa and tensile strength of 160 MPa (Aalco datasheet), against about 240 MPa yield for 6061-T6. The highest stress in the 12 mm parts is about 53 MPa in the side-plate feet at the worst-case 16.8 kN, a factor of about 2.3 on proof stress; the side-plate tension (9 MPa) and the roof-block screw bearing (about 44 MPa) are lower. The front-edge M6 holes already have Helicoils; the lug M6 holes (F) and the base plate's M8 guide-pin holes (C) carry only the housing weight and spring loads, so plain threads with full engagement are enough.

6060 is softer and gummier to machine than 6061: use sharp, polished cutters with lubricant, and take light passes on both faces in case the extruded bar is bowed.

Order along the bar	Part	Blank, across × along (mm)	Saw cut	Running length (mm)
1	Side plate	133 × 192 (finished 130 × 189)	3.5	195.5
2	Side plate	133 × 192 (finished 130 × 189)	3.5	391
3	Base plate	118 × 110 (finished 115 × 107)	3.5	504.5
4	Mount plate	103 × 103 (finished 100 × 100)	—	607.5

Square the bar end first. Mill each blank's width down from the 160: side plates 27 off, base plate 42 off, mount plate 57 off (or saw the strip off first). Keep the two side-plate blanks together; they are machined as a pair.

Stock	Part	Cuts	Spare	Status
20 × 65 × 50	Roof block (19 × 60 × 42)	None: mill the 50 to 42, the 65 to 60, and skim to 19	2.5 a side on each dimension	Ordered and received 6 Nov 2026
10 × 30 × 100	Thrust bar (10 × 30 × 42) and stop block (10 × 20 × 42)	Two blanks of 44 (44 + 3.5 + 44 = 91.5); mill the stop block down to 20 wide	About 8.5	Ordered and received 6 Nov 2026
25 × 20 × 100	Two lugs (40 × 24 × 20)	Two blanks of 42 (42 + 3.5 + 42 = 87.5)	About 12.5 (ordered 100 long rather than 90, which would have left only 2.5)	Ordered and received 6 Nov 2026

The bar needs to be at least 608 long; 1000 was bought (6 Nov 2026), so about 390 × 160 is left after the four blanks: enough to remake any part, including both side plates. The strips beside each blank (27, 42 and 57 wide) are the spare; nothing else in the design needs 12 mm.

Machining sequence: wedge and anvil. Both come out of the Ø50 bar with every face cleaning up (wedge section diagonal 47.2 mm and anvil 46.8 mm, including grinding allowance).

1. Turn the two thrust washers off the end of the Ø50 bar first (see the guidance table), then saw an 82 mm wedge blank and a 42 mm anvil blank. With only 1 mm a side to face, check the saw cuts are square before facing.
2. Wedge: hold the blank in a V-block, mill one flat, turn onto it and mill the opposite face to 24.1 (23.5 plus 0.3 per face to grind). Mill the sides to 40.6, then the ends square to 80.0.
3. Mill the 9.5° underside, leaving 0.3 to grind: as a ramp on the CNC, or with the block on a 9.5° angle plate. The leading end comes out at about 10.7 before grinding.
4. Trailing end: spot on the centreline 12.05 below the as-milled top (11.75 plus the 0.3 top allowance). Drill Ø12.5 to 18 deep and flat-bottom it, then tap M14 × 1.5 to 14 full thread with a bottoming tap.
5. Anvil: square the blank to 40.6 × 23.3 × 40 the same way. Mill the 9.5° top leaving 0.3, then ream the two Ø5 H7 holes 6 deep, 20.3 from the as-milled thrust face and 8.3 above the as-milled underside.
6. Deburr, radius any internal corners, break edges 0.3, and stamp a mark on a non-working face.

7. Heat-treat the wedge, anvil, push pad and both thrust washers together, following the 4140 column of the heat-treat table.
8. Grind as in steps 7–10 of the table, then check the match on the surface plate.
9. Press the two Ø5 m6 × 10 dowels into the anvil, 4 mm proud each side.

Machining guidance: the other parts. The 4140 is supplied pre-hardened (Atlas quotes 269–331 HB; check Edcon's certificate for the actual condition), so carbide tooling is the easier choice. The collar and drawbar follow their own detail sections.

Part	From	Sequence	Watch
Thrust washers (2)	End of the Ø50 4140 bar, before sawing (14 mm of it)	Chuck the bar; face; turn the OD to 32 for 14 mm; drill and bore 11.30 +0.05/0; part off at 4.3, face, part off at 3.3; face the parted sides; harden with the wedge batch; lap to 4.0 and 3.0	Faces flat and parallel within 0.01; lap on a plate with figure-of-eight strokes
Push pad	Ø16 4140 offcut	Face to 8.0; drill 9.9 (25/64″) to 6.0 and flat-bottom with an end mill; bottoming tap 7/16-20; check on the drawbar; harden	Top face square to the thread within 0.02. Six mm of thread carries the 16.8 kN worst case at about 160 MPa thread shear (my calculation), so the drawbar end touching the floor is not essential
Side plates (2)	12 mm 6060 (12 × 160 bar)	Screw the two blanks back to back; machine the outline, window, notch and all through-holes as a pair; separate; mill the lift and spring pockets on each inner face as mirror images; drill the front-edge M6 and the feet Ø6.6 with each plate on edge in the vice	Window 16.2 +0.1/0 high so the fork slides; inside corners R2; drill the dowel holes Ø5.8 for now and ream them with the roof block in place
Roof block	20 mm 6061-T6 plate	Mill to 19 × 60 × 42 −0/−0.05; tap 4 × M8 14 deep in the ends; Ø3.4 holes counterbored Ø6.5 for the wear plate	The 42 sets the plate spacing and its ends set the plates parallel: ends square to the base within 0.02
Fork plate	16 mm mild steel	Mill to 92 × 66 × 16.0 −0/−0.1; cut the 54 +0.2/0 slot with its R27 end on the CNC; tap 4 × M6 12 deep from below; break the slot edges 0.5	Top face flat (fly-cut): it bears on the collar flange
Base plate	12 mm 6060 (12 × 160 bar)	Profile, R47 and slot on the CNC; drill A and B Ø6.6; drill and tap C M8 with the plate flat on the table; drill D Ø5.8 for now	C square to the face within 0.05: it sets the guide pins vertical
Guide pins (2)	Ø12 h6 ground rod	Cut to 140; turn an M8 spigot 11 long with a small undercut; face the shoulder in the same setting; die-cut M8 × 1.25; chamfer the top	The shoulder squareness is what keeps the pin vertical

Part	From	Sequence	Watch
Lugs (2)	25 × 20 6061-T6 flat, 2 × 42	Mill to 40 × 24 × 20; drill and ream Ø16 H7 through, centred on the 40 and 14 from the mounting face; press in the bush and ream it Ø12 H8 afterwards; drill 2 × Ø7 at 28 centres	The Ø7 holes give a little float for fitting on the pins (below)
Mount plate	12 mm 6060 (12 × 160 bar)	Profile 100 × 100; bore Ø40; spot the 4 × Ø13 from the cylinder's own front threads; drill 4 × Ø6.6	Spot the 74.07 pattern from the cylinder rather than marking it out; fit steel thread inserts in the side plates' front-edge M6 holes, since this plate comes off whenever the cylinder does
Thrust bar, stop block	10 × 30 6061-T6 flat	Mill to 42 −0/−0.1 with square ends; tap 2 × M5 12 deep in each end; bar: 2 × M3 for the bronze strip; block: M8 through	Same 42 as the roof block; stop block's M8 square to the face within 0.05
Cage cross pins (4)	Ø5 W1	Cut about 75; groove for e-clips just outside each plate	Check the length on the assembled plates; no hardening needed

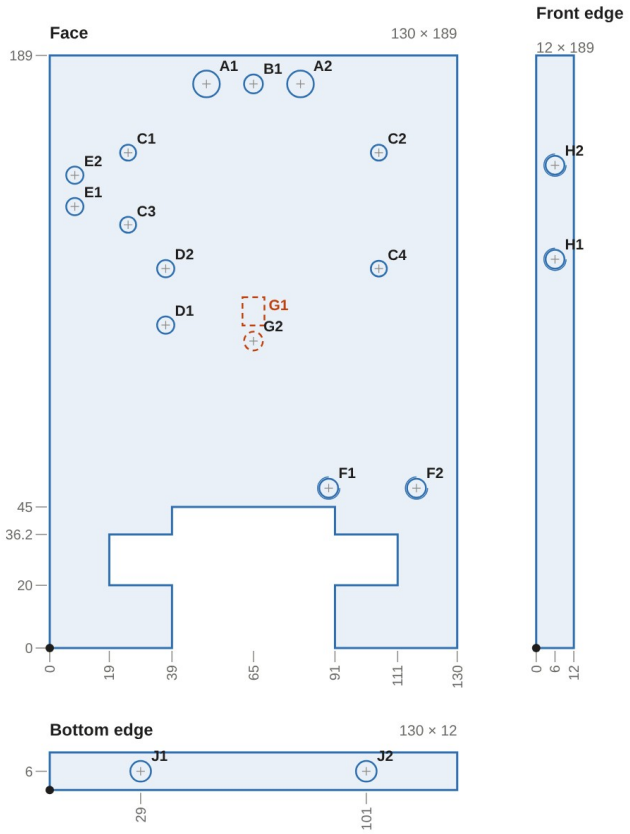
Plate parts: hole positions from 0,0 (added 5 Nov 2026)

Every plate part is drawn on its own below, with each hole's centre as x, y in mm from 0,0 at the lower-left corner of the view named (zero your DRO or CNC work offset on that corner). This supersedes reading positions off the assembly drawings above, which use X/Z from the spindle axis; the positions are the same, converted. Tapped holes give the tap size and its drill; Ø6 H7 holes are drilled Ø5.8 and reamed. The coordinate conversion is my arithmetic from the existing drawings.

Side plate (2 off, mirrored pair). 12 mm 6060 (from the 12 × 160 bar). View from the machine's left, front to the right; 0,0 = rear bottom corner (X −65, Z −37).

Side plate (2 off, mirrored pair)

12 mm 6060 (from the 12 × 160 bar). View from the machine's left, front to the right; 0,0 = rear bottom corner (X −65, Z −37).



Hole chart (mm from 0,0 of its view)

ID	x	y	Size · depth
A1	50	179.9	Ø8.5 · thru
A2	80	179.9	Ø8.5 · thru
B1	65	179.9	Ø6 H7 · thru, ream with roof block
C1	25	158	Ø5.1 · thru
C2	105	158	Ø5.1 · thru
C3	25	135	Ø5.1 · thru
C4	105	121	Ø5.1 · thru
D1	37	103	Ø5.5 · thru
D2	37	121	Ø5.5 · thru
E1	8	140.8	Ø5.5 · thru
E2	8	150.8	Ø5.5 · thru
F1	89	51	M6 (drill Ø5.0) · thru
F2	117	51	M6 (drill Ø5.0) · thru
G2	65	97.9	Ø6 spring pocket · Z 92.9–102.9
H1	6	124	M6 Helicoil · 15 deep
H2	6	154	M6 Helicoil · 15 deep
J1	29	6	Ø6.6 · thru the 20 foot
J2	101	6	Ø6.6 · thru the 20 foot

Window 92 × 16.2 (x 19–111, y 20–36.2) takes the fork; slot 52 wide (x 39–91) open to y 45. Inside corners R2.
G1: anvil lift pocket 7 × 9 × 3.5 deep, inner face only. G2: Ø6 × 10 spring pocket below it, on the pocket centre line.
Machine both plates stacked; coordinates are the same for both in this view. Pockets go on the two inner faces.
Edge views: x across the 12 thickness (H, J at mid-thickness 6). H in the front edge (x 130 on the face view), J up through each foot.

Dots mark 0,0. Ordinates are mm from 0,0. Arc over a hole = tapped; double circle = counterbore; dashed = pocket or hidden.

ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
A1	Face	50	179.9	Ø8.5	thru
A2	Face	80	179.9	Ø8.5	thru
B1	Face	65	179.9	Ø6 H7	thru, ream with roof block
C1	Face	25	158	Ø5.1	thru

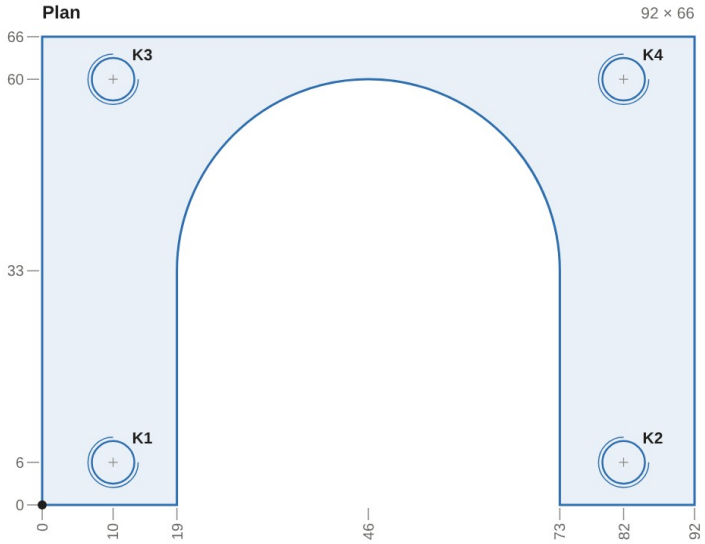
ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
C2	Face	105	158	Ø5.1	thru
C3	Face	25	135	Ø5.1	thru
C4	Face	105	121	Ø5.1	thru
D1	Face	37	103	Ø5.5	thru
D2	Face	37	121	Ø5.5	thru
E1	Face	8	140.8	Ø5.5	thru
E2	Face	8	150.8	Ø5.5	thru
F1	Face	89	51	M6 (drill Ø5.0)	thru
F2	Face	117	51	M6 (drill Ø5.0)	thru
G2	Face	65	97.9	Ø6 spring pocket	Z 92.9–102.9
H1	Front edge	6	124	M6 Helicoil	15 deep
H2	Front edge	6	154	M6 Helicoil	15 deep
J1	Bottom edge	29	6	Ø6.6	thru the 20 foot
J2	Bottom edge	101	6	Ø6.6	thru the 20 foot

Window 92 × 16.2 (x 19–111, y 20–36.2) takes the fork; slot 52 wide (x 39–91) open to y 45. Inside corners R2. G1: anvil lift pocket 7 × 9 × 3.5 deep, inner face only. G2: Ø6 × 10 spring pocket below it, on the pocket centre line. Machine both plates stacked; coordinates are the same for both in this view. Pockets go on the two inner faces. Edge views: x across the 12 thickness (H, J at mid-thickness 6). H in the front edge (x 130 on the face view), J up through each foot.

Fork plate (1 off). 16 mm mild steel. Plan from above, open end of the slot at the bottom; 0,0 = lower-left corner.

Fork plate (1 off)

16 mm mild steel. Plan from above, open end of the slot at the bottom; 0,0 = lower-left corner.



Hole chart (mm from 0,0 of its view)

ID	x	y	Size · depth
K1	10	6	M6 (drill Ø5.0) · 12 deep from below
K2	82	6	M6 (drill Ø5.0) · 12 deep from below
K3	10	60	M6 (drill Ø5.0) · 12 deep from below
K4	82	60	M6 (drill Ø5.0) · 12 deep from below

Slot 54 +0.2/0 wide (x 19–73), open at y 0, closed end R27 centred at (46, 33).
Top face flat (fly-cut): it bears on the collar flange. Break the slot edges 0.5.

Dots mark 0,0. Ordinates are mm from 0,0. Arc over a hole = tapped; double circle = counterbore; dashed = pocket or hidden.

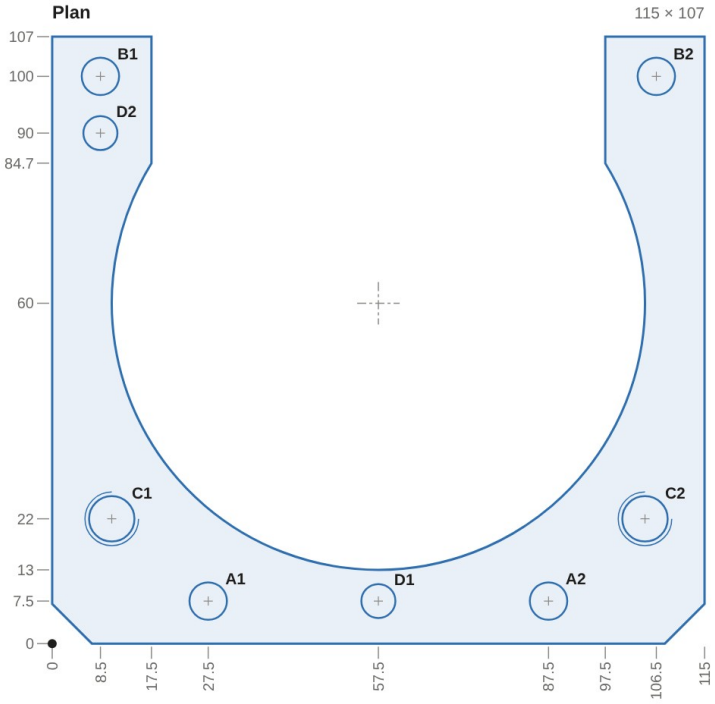
ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
K1	Plan	10	6	M6 (drill Ø5.0)	12 deep from below
K2	Plan	82	6	M6 (drill Ø5.0)	12 deep from below
K3	Plan	10	60	M6 (drill Ø5.0)	12 deep from below
K4	Plan	82	60	M6 (drill Ø5.0)	12 deep from below

Slot 54 +0.2/0 wide (x 19–73), open at y 0, closed end R27 centred at (46, 33). Top face flat (fly-cut): it bears on the collar flange. Break the slot edges 0.5.

Head-top base plate (1 off). 12 mm 6060 (from the 12 × 160 bar). Plan from above, front at the bottom; 0,0 = front-left corner. Spindle axis at (57.5, 60).

Head-top base plate (1 off)

12 mm 6060 (from the 12 × 160 bar). Plan from above, front at the bottom; 0,0 = front-left corner. Spindle axis at (57.5, 60).



Hole chart (mm from 0,0 of its view)

ID	x	y	Size · depth
A1	27.5	7.5	Ø6.6 · thru
A2	87.5	7.5	Ø6.6 · thru
B1	8.5	100	Ø6.6 · thru
B2	106.5	100	Ø6.6 · thru
C1	10.5	22	M8 (drill Ø6.8) · thru, square within 0.05
C2	104.5	22	M8 (drill Ø6.8) · thru, square within 0.05
D1	57.5	7.5	Ø6 H7 · thru; drill Ø5.8, ream on the head
D2	8.5	90	Ø6 H7 · thru; drill Ø5.8, ream on the head

Front corners chamfered 7 × 7. Cut-out R47 on the spindle axis, opening into a slot 80 wide (x 17.5–97.5) to the rear edge.
D1 leaves a 2.5 web to the R47 cut-out: drill it after profiling and deburr gently.
A and B: spot through onto the head, drill Ø5.0 through the 9 mm casting and tap M6.

Dots mark 0,0. Ordinates are mm from 0,0. Arc over a hole = tapped; double circle = counterbore; dashed = pocket or hidden.

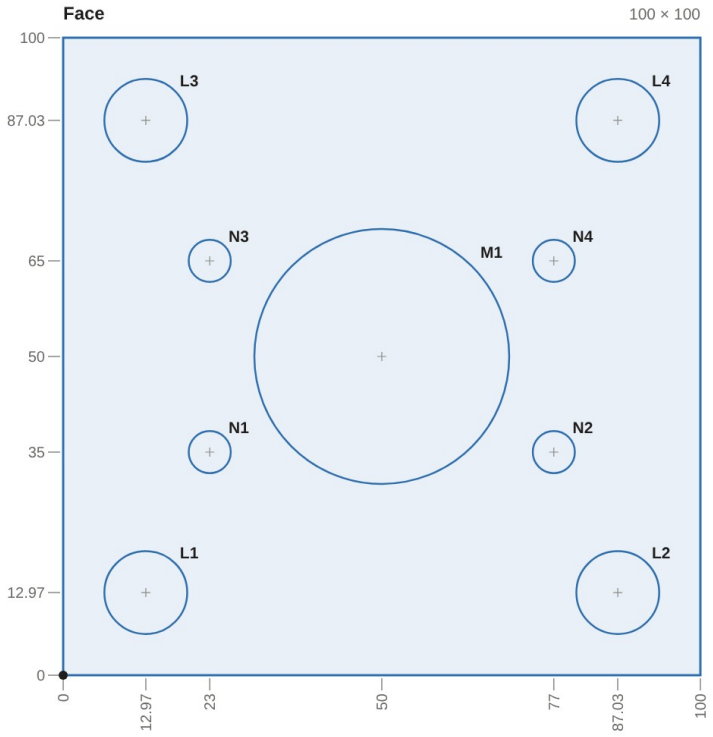
ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
A1	Plan	27.5	7.5	Ø6.6	thru
A2	Plan	87.5	7.5	Ø6.6	thru
B1	Plan	8.5	100	Ø6.6	thru
B2	Plan	106.5	100	Ø6.6	thru
C1	Plan	10.5	22	M8 (drill Ø6.8)	thru, square within 0.05
C2	Plan	104.5	22	M8 (drill Ø6.8)	thru, square within 0.05
D1	Plan	57.5	7.5	Ø6 H7	thru; drill Ø5.8, ream on the head
D2	Plan	8.5	90	Ø6 H7	thru; drill Ø5.8, ream on the head

Front corners chamfered 7 × 7. Cut-out R47 on the spindle axis, opening into a slot 80 wide (x 17.5–97.5) to the rear edge. D1 leaves a 2.5 web to the R47 cut-out: drill it after profiling and deburr gently. A and B: spot through onto the head, drill Ø5.0 through the 9 mm casting and tap M6.

Cylinder mount plate (1 off). 12 mm 6060 (from the 12 × 160 bar). Either face (symmetric); 0,0 = lower-left corner. Centre (50, 50) on the cylinder axis, Z 102.

Cylinder mount plate (1 off)

12 mm 6060 (from the 12 × 160 bar). Either face (symmetric); 0,0 = lower-left corner. Centre (50, 50) on the cylinder axis, Z 102.



Hole chart (mm from 0,0 of its view)

ID	x	y	Size · depth
L1	12.97	12.97	Ø13 · thru
L2	87.03	12.97	Ø13 · thru
L3	12.97	87.03	Ø13 · thru
L4	87.03	87.03	Ø13 · thru
M1	50	50	Ø40 bore · thru
N1	23	35	Ø6.6 · thru
N2	77	35	Ø6.6 · thru
N3	23	65	Ø6.6 · thru
N4	77	65	Ø6.6 · thru

L: 74.07 square for the M12 cylinder screws; spot them from the cylinder itself rather than marking out.
N: M6 × 25 into the side plates' front edges (Z 87 and 117).

Dots mark 0,0. Ordinates are mm from 0,0. Arc over a hole = tapped; double circle = counterbore; dashed = pocket or hidden.

ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
L1	Face	12.97	12.97	Ø13	thru
L2	Face	87.03	12.97	Ø13	thru
L3	Face	12.97	87.03	Ø13	thru
L4	Face	87.03	87.03	Ø13	thru
M1	Face	50	50	Ø40 bore	thru
N1	Face	23	35	Ø6.6	thru
N2	Face	77	35	Ø6.6	thru
N3	Face	23	65	Ø6.6	thru

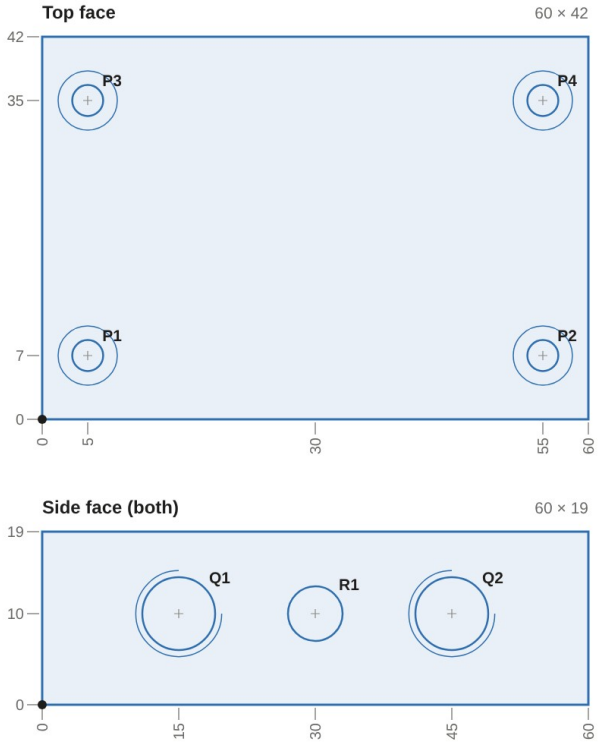
ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
N4	Face	77	65	Ø6.6	thru

L: 74.07 square for the M12 cylinder screws; spot them from the cylinder itself rather than marking out. N: M6 × 25 into the side plates' front edges (Z 87 and 117).

Roof block (1 off). 6061-T6, 60 × 42 × 19 from 20 mm plate. 0,0 = lower-left of each view; x along the wedge travel.

Roof block (1 off)

6061-T6, 60 × 42 × 19 from 20 mm plate. 0,0 = lower-left of each view; x along the wedge travel.



Hole chart (mm from 0,0 of its view)

ID	x	y	Size · depth
P1	5	7	Ø3.4, c'bore Ø6.5 × 3.5 · thru
P2	55	7	Ø3.4, c'bore Ø6.5 × 3.5 · thru
P3	5	35	Ø3.4, c'bore Ø6.5 × 3.5 · thru
P4	55	35	Ø3.4, c'bore Ø6.5 × 3.5 · thru
Q1	15	10	M8 (drill Ø6.8 × 17) · 14 deep
Q2	45	10	M8 (drill Ø6.8 × 17) · 14 deep
R1	30	10	Ø6 H7 · 10 deep

42 −0/−0.05 wide: it sets the side-plate spacing. Side faces square to the base within 0.02.
Q and R on both 60 × 19 side faces (the faces against the side plates).

Dots mark 0,0. Ordinates are mm from 0,0. Arc over a hole = tapped; double circle = counterbore; dashed = pocket or hidden.

ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
P1	Top face	5	7	Ø3.4, c'bore Ø6.5 × 3.5	thru
P2	Top face	55	7	Ø3.4, c'bore Ø6.5 × 3.5	thru
P3	Top face	5	35	Ø3.4, c'bore Ø6.5 × 3.5	thru

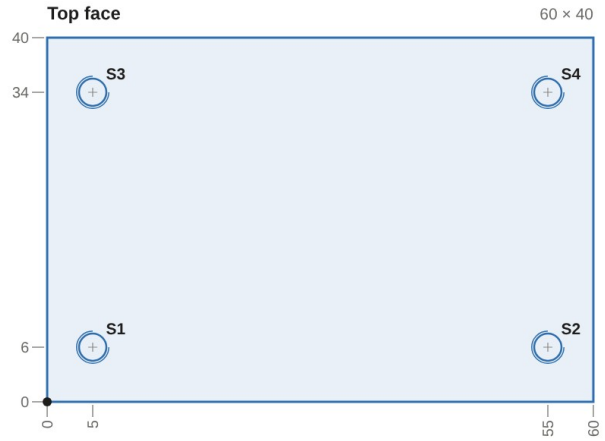
ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
P4	Top face	55	35	Ø3.4, c'bore Ø6.5 × 3.5	thru
Q1	Side face (both)	15	10	M8 (drill Ø6.8 × 17)	14 deep
Q2	Side face (both)	45	10	M8 (drill Ø6.8 × 17)	14 deep
R1	Side face (both)	30	10	Ø6 H7	10 deep

42 −0/−0.05 wide: it sets the side-plate spacing. Side faces square to the base within 0.02. Q and R on both 60 × 19 side faces (the faces against the side plates).

Roof wear plate (1 off). O1 ground flat stock 40 × 5, 60 long. Top (non-rolling) face; 0,0 = lower-left corner.

Roof wear plate (1 off)

O1 ground flat stock 40 × 5, 60 long. Top (non-rolling) face; 0,0 = lower-left corner.



Hole chart (mm from 0,0 of its view)

ID	x	y	Size · depth
S1	5	6	M3 (drill Ø2.5 × 3.2 flat) · 3 deep
S2	55	6	M3 (drill Ø2.5 × 3.2 flat) · 3 deep
S3	5	34	M3 (drill Ø2.5 × 3.2 flat) · 3 deep
S4	55	34	M3 (drill Ø2.5 × 3.2 flat) · 3 deep

Drill and tap before hardening; 1.8 of skin is left, so the rolling face stays unbroken.
Harden 58–62 HRC, grind both faces parallel within 0.005.

Dots mark 0,0. Ordinates are mm from 0,0. Arc over a hole = tapped; double circle = counterbore; dashed = pocket or hidden.

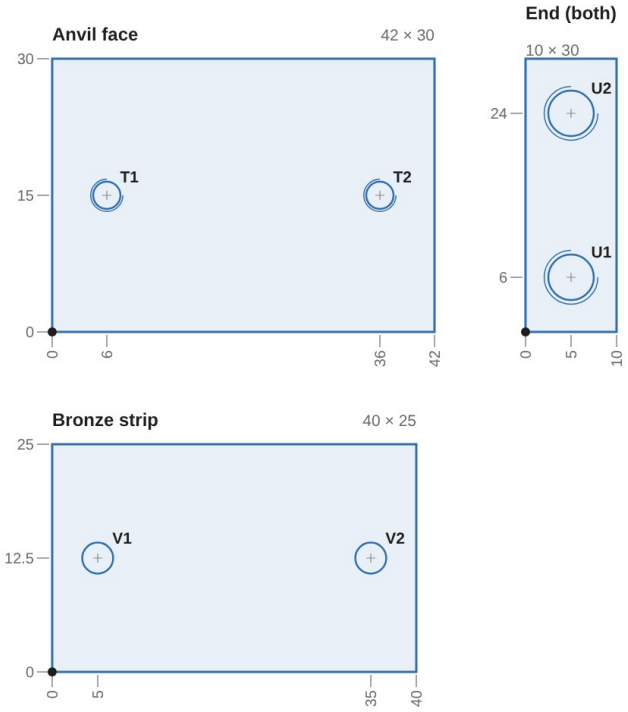
ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
S1	Top face	5	6	M3 (drill Ø2.5 × 3.2 flat)	3 deep
S2	Top face	55	6	M3 (drill Ø2.5 × 3.2 flat)	3 deep
S3	Top face	5	34	M3 (drill Ø2.5 × 3.2 flat)	3 deep
S4	Top face	55	34	M3 (drill Ø2.5 × 3.2 flat)	3 deep

Drill and tap before hardening; 1.8 of skin is left, so the rolling face stays unbroken. Harden 58–62 HRC, grind both faces parallel within 0.005.

Rear thrust bar and bronze strip (1 off each). Bar 6061-T6 42 × 30 × 10; strip bronze 40 × 25 × 3. 0,0 = lower-left of each view.

Rear thrust bar and bronze strip (1 off each)

Bar 6061-T6 42 × 30 × 10; strip bronze 40 × 25 × 3. 0,0 = lower-left of each view.



Hole chart (mm from 0,0 of its view)

ID	x	y	Size · depth
T1	6	15	M3 (drill Ø2.5) · 8 deep
T2	36	15	M3 (drill Ø2.5) · 8 deep
U1	5	6	M5 (drill Ø4.2 × 15) · 12 deep
U2	5	24	M5 (drill Ø4.2 × 15) · 12 deep
V1	5	12.5	Ø3.4, 90° csk · thru
V2	35	12.5	Ø3.4, 90° csk · thru

42 −0/−0.1 long with square ends. Strip sits 1 in from each end and 2.5 from each long edge; heads 0.3 below the bronze face.

Dots mark 0,0. Ordinates are mm from 0,0. Arc over a hole = tapped; double circle = counterbore; dashed = pocket or hidden.

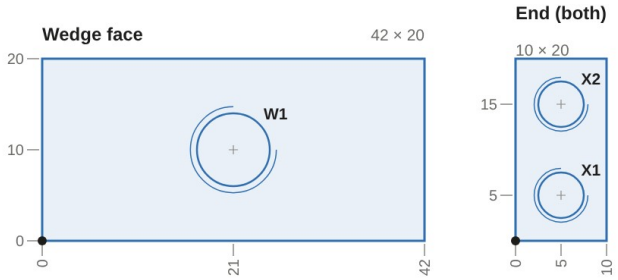
ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
T1	Anvil face	6	15	M3 (drill Ø2.5)	8 deep
T2	Anvil face	36	15	M3 (drill Ø2.5)	8 deep
U1	End (both)	5	6	M5 (drill Ø4.2 × 15)	12 deep
U2	End (both)	5	24	M5 (drill Ø4.2 × 15)	12 deep
V1	Bronze strip	5	12.5	Ø3.4, 90° csk	thru
V2	Bronze strip	35	12.5	Ø3.4, 90° csk	thru

42 −0/−0.1 long with square ends. Strip sits 1 in from each end and 2.5 from each long edge; heads 0.3 below the bronze face.

Rear stop block (1 off). 6061-T6 42 × 20 × 10. 0,0 = lower-left of each view.

Rear stop block (1 off)

6061-T6 42 × 20 × 10. 0,0 = lower-left of each view.



Hole chart (mm from 0,0 of its view)

ID	x	y	Size · depth
W1	21	10	M8 (drill Ø6.8) · thru, square within 0.05
X1	5	5	M5 (drill Ø4.2 × 15) · 12 deep
X2	5	15	M5 (drill Ø4.2 × 15) · 12 deep

42 −0/−0.1 long with square ends. M8 × 30 set screw and lock nut in W1 sets the wedge stop.

Dots mark 0,0. Ordinates are mm from 0,0. Arc over a hole = tapped; double circle = counterbore; dashed = pocket or hidden.

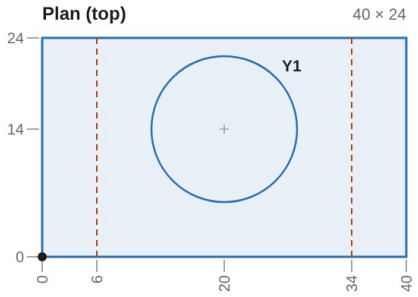
ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
W1	Wedge face	21	10	M8 (drill Ø6.8)	thru, square within 0.05
X1	End (both)	5	5	M5 (drill Ø4.2 × 15)	12 deep
X2	End (both)	5	15	M5 (drill Ø4.2 × 15)	12 deep

42 −0/−0.1 long with square ends. M8 × 30 set screw and lock nut in W1 sets the wedge stop.

Float lug (2 off). 6061-T6 40 × 24 × 20 from 25 × 20 flat. 0,0 = lower-left; mounting face at y 0 in the plan.

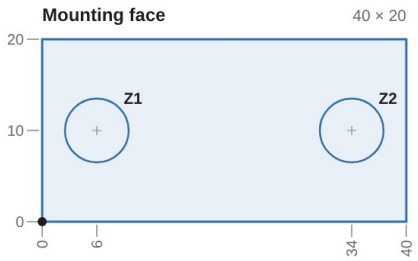
Float lug (2 off)

6061-T6 40 × 24 × 20 from 25 × 20 flat. 0,0 = lower-left; mounting face at y 0 in the plan.



Hole chart (mm from 0,0 of its view)

ID	x	y	Size · depth
Y1	20	14	Ø16 H7 (bush, then ream Ø12 H8) · thru the 20
Z1	6	10	Ø7 · thru the 24
Z2	34	10	Ø7 · thru the 24



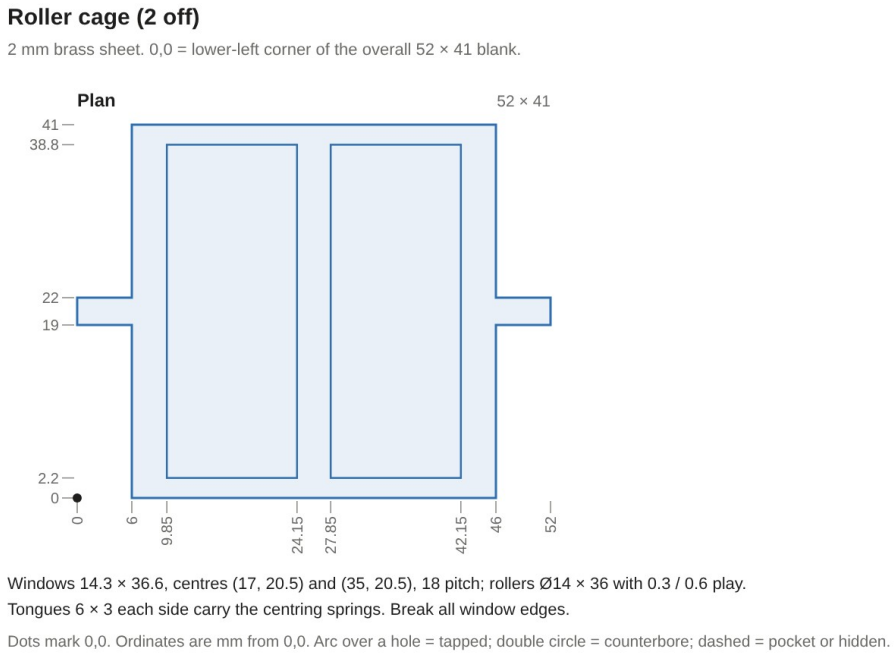
Bush bore leaves a 2 wall on the outer face (24 − 14 − 8): light duty only, but take care when reaming.
Z1, Z2 at 28 centres match the side plate F1, F2; Ø7 gives a little float for fitting on the pins.

Dots mark 0,0. Ordinates are mm from 0,0. Arc over a hole = tapped; double circle = counterbore; dashed = pocket or hidden.

ID	View	x	y	Size	Depth / note
Y1	Plan (top)	20	14	Ø16 H7 (bush, then ream Ø12 H8)	thru the 20
Z1	Mounting face	6	10	Ø7	thru the 24
Z2	Mounting face	34	10	Ø7	thru the 24

Bush bore leaves a 2 wall on the outer face (24 − 14 − 8): light duty only, but take care when reaming. Z1, Z2 at 28 centres match the side plate F1, F2; Ø7 gives a little float for fitting on the pins.

Roller cage (2 off). 2 mm brass sheet. 0,0 = lower-left corner of the overall 52 × 41 blank.



Windows 14.3 × 36.6, centres (17, 20.5) and (35, 20.5), 18 pitch; rollers Ø14 × 36 with 0.3 / 0.6 play. Tongues 6 × 3 each side carry the centring springs. Break all window edges.

Fitting the housing to the head.

1. Build the housing on its side, in this order, because the anvil's lift pins stand 4 mm proud each side and cannot go in once both plates are on: (a) lay one side plate down, inner face up; (b) the anvil with its two lift pins in that plate's pocket, lift springs in the spring pocket; (c) the thrust bar with its bronze strip, M5s finger-tight; (d) the lower cage with its two rollers on the anvil slope; (e) the wedge, with the JA stud and nut already fitted, on the lower rollers; (f) the upper cage and rollers on the wedge; (g) the wear plate screwed to the roof block, then the roof block on top; (h) the second side plate, catching the lift pins in its pocket; (i) the stop block. Then fit the M8s finger-tight, ream both Ø6 dowel holes through plate and block together, fit the dowels and tighten everything. Last, the four cage cross pins with their springs and e-clips. Check the wedge runs its full stroke by hand before going on.
2. Scrape the paint from the head top under the base plate. Turn a centring ring, bore Ø90 to fit the boss and OD Ø94 to fit the plate's cut-out, about 4 high. With the ring locating the plate, spot A and B through onto the head, drill Ø5.0 through the 9 mm top (grease the drill, vacuum the chips) and tap M6.
3. Screw the plate down, then drill and ream the two D holes Ø6 through the plate and 8 deep into the head; fit the dowels. Remove the ring.
4. Screw in the guide pins with retaining compound and fit the rest collars low.

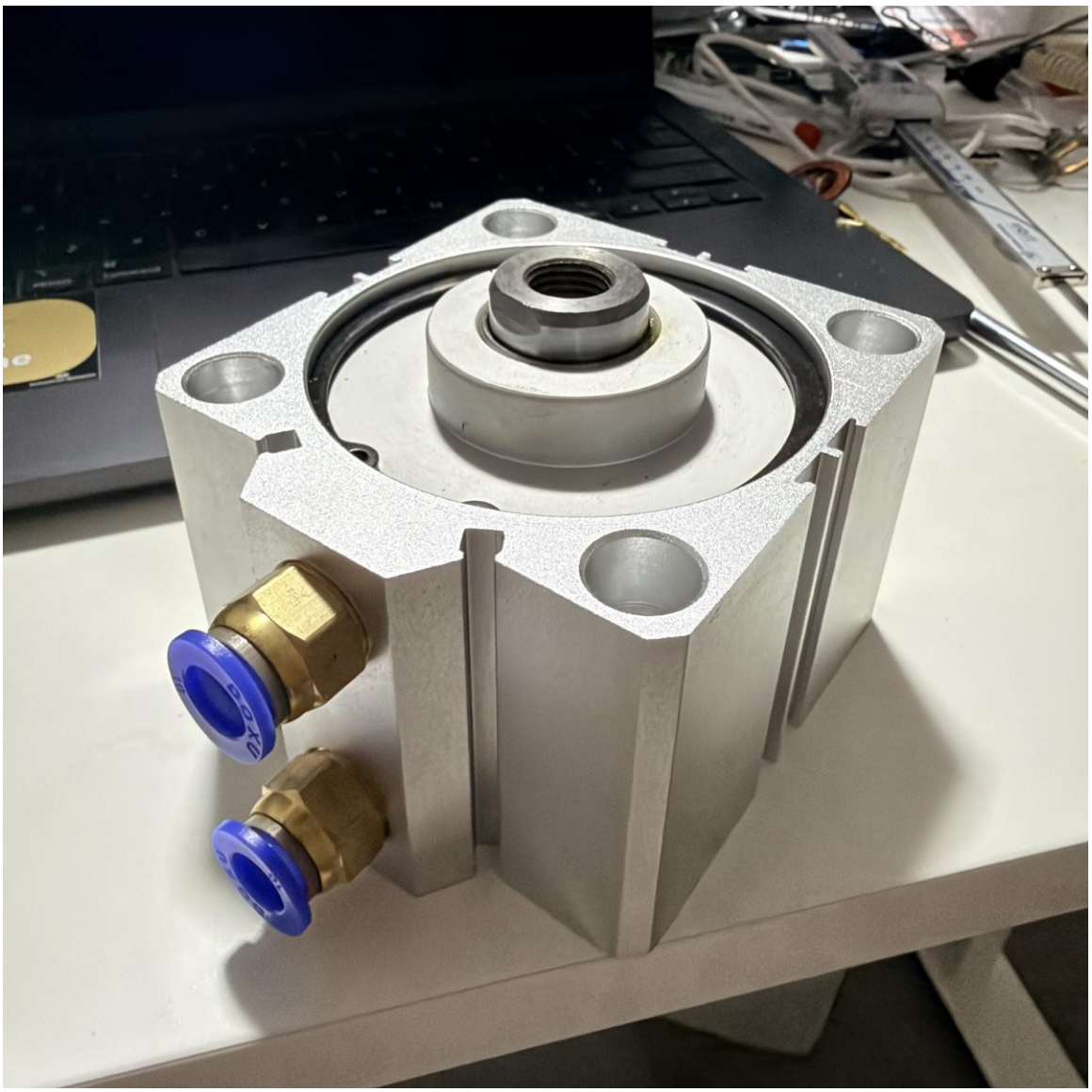
5. Fit the lugs loosely to the side plates, lower the housing onto the pins with the anvil clear of the push pad, and slide the fork in under the collar flange; fit its four screws. Raise the rest collars until the fork-to-flange gap is 0.5–1 mm on feelers, then tighten the lug screws with the housing hanging free on the pins. Fit the springs and top collars.
6. Fit the cylinder and JA joint, set the spacer-tube length, then transfer the mount plate's M6 holes into the side plates' front edges and tap them.

Air lines and valve (added 7 Nov 2026; my suggestion, not from a source). The cylinder rides on the floating housing, which moves with the head through 240 mm of Z and lifts about 1 mm on release. Mount the valve on the head's left side next to the cylinder ports, so the two 10 mm lines to the cylinder stay short, with a small slack loop for the float. Fix the filter-regulator to the column or stand where its gauge is visible, and run the supply to the valve with a loop, or in a drag chain, long enough for full Z travel. Point the silenced exhausts away from the operator. The coil cable follows the supply line and enters the casting through the front faceplate with the button wiring.

Reverting to a manual drawbar (requirement 6). Taking the housing off is quick: undo the four fork screws, slide the fork out and lift the housing off its guide pins. The collar, stack and drawbar stay on the spindle and still clamp the tool, but a tool can't then be released by hand, because it takes about 12 kN at the push pad. To go back to manual use, take off the push pad, jam nut and preload nut, lift out the stack and drawbar, unclamp the collar, and fit a manual drawbar. The original 7/16-20 drawbar no longer fits the new M12 × 1.75 flat-nose collet, so either refit the original collet with it or make a plain M12 × 1.75 manual drawbar. The base plate and guide pins can stay; they don't get in the way of manual use.

Cylinder

Cylinder as fitted: SDA 80 × 25 (measured 28 Oct 2026)



Feature	Measured	Notes
Bore × stroke	80 × 25 mm	Force is set by the bore, so it is the same as the 80 × 30: 2.51 kN at 5.0 bar
Body	94 mm square (94.07 measured) × 66.28 mm	Rear face to front face. Rear face is flat, with an 82.6 mm rebate down to a near-flush Ø45 centre
Width over the port boss	104 mm	Both ports central on one side face (the face the label calls the top); the fittings stand out further than this
Rod end, retracted	78.41 mm from the rear face	Rod boss 70.9 mm from the rear face; the rod stands 12.1 mm proud of the front face
Rod end, extended	about 103.4 mm (derived: 78.41 + 25)	Not measured; stroke taken as the nominal 25
Mounting holes	4 × M12 × 1.75 on a 74.07 mm square (centres 10 mm in from each edge). From	Both faces tapped the same (measured)

Feature	Measured	Notes
	each face: 14 mm plain, then 14 mm of thread; a 10 mm clear bore joins the two, so an M10 bolt passes right through	
Rod end thread	Female M14 × 1.5 (re-measured; first recorded as M12 × 1.75), 32 mm of thread in a 33 mm deep hole	Rod diameter 25.00 mm (measured)
Ports	PC10-03 push-in: 10 mm tube, R3/8 thread	Already fitted. Mounted with the ports facing the machine's left; the square hole pattern allows any of four positions
Mass	1.199 kg including the fittings	Used in the lever vs wedge comparison (was assumed 1.5 kg)
Label and rating	LAIZE SDA80×25, 0.15–0.8 MPa	0.8 MPa is well above the 0.62 MPa supply; the regulator runs it at 0.50
Magnetic piston	No	No reed switch is possible. Wedge position is not sensed; the K1 auxiliary contact is the interlock
Rod side play	Not measured (sheet item 7.13)	The floating joint takes up misalignment, so this is information only

What the 25 mm stroke changes. Nothing on force. On travel, the normal release needs 13.2 mm, the hard stop 15 mm and the washer-flat limit 17.4 mm, so at least 7.6 mm of stroke stays unused. The calculator now has S = 25 and still shows OK; the largest drawbar stroke the cylinder could cover is 2.7 mm, more than the washers allow.

Air. Extending 15 mm sweeps about 75 cm^3, so about 0.45 L of free air at 5.0 bar, and the return stroke uses a similar amount. That is under 1 L per tool change against a 9 CFM (about 255 L/min) supply, so the 10 mm tubing is more than enough. Release speed is set by the valve and the flow controls, not the tube.

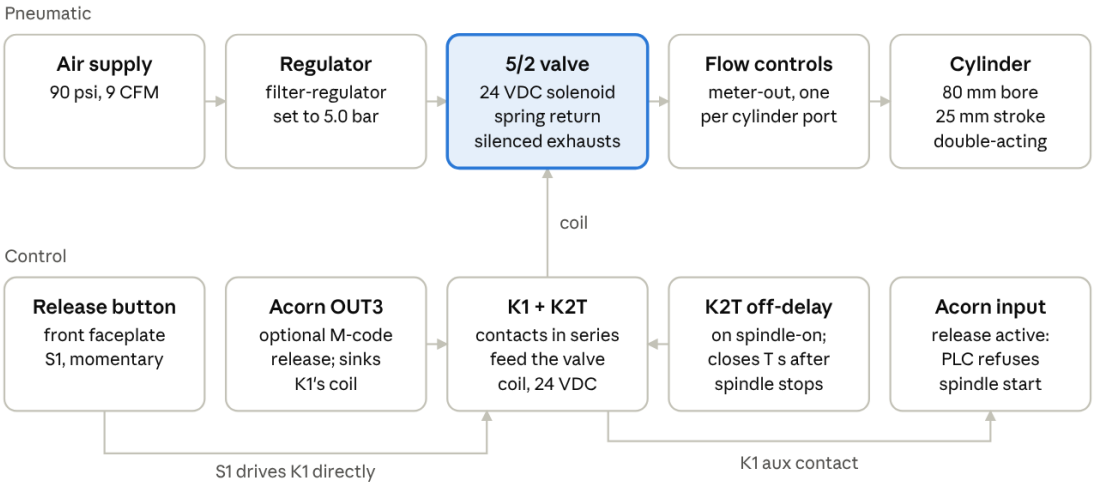
Valve. The control power supply has a spare 24 VDC output for the coil. A 5/2 single-solenoid, spring-return, internally piloted valve with 1/4 BSP ports suits this, for example the Airtac 4V210-08 24 VDC (reseller listing: 1/4" BSP ports, 21–114 psi, about 1.5–7.9 bar). Use a DIN coil plug with an LED and suppression. Coil current should be checked against the supply's spare capacity and the relay contact rating once a valve is chosen.

Pneumatic and control circuit

The valve is single-solenoid with spring return, so the tool stays clamped unless air, 24 V and an Acorn release signal are all present and the spindle is stopped. Loss of any one leaves the cylinder retracted and the washers clamping.

Release needs air, power and a stopped spindle

Pneumatic path above, control path below; K1 and K2T contacts in series feed the valve coil.



Power or air lost: the valve springs back, the wedge retracts, the anvil lifts clear and the washers keep the tool clamped.

pneumatic and control circuit · air path, release logic, interlock

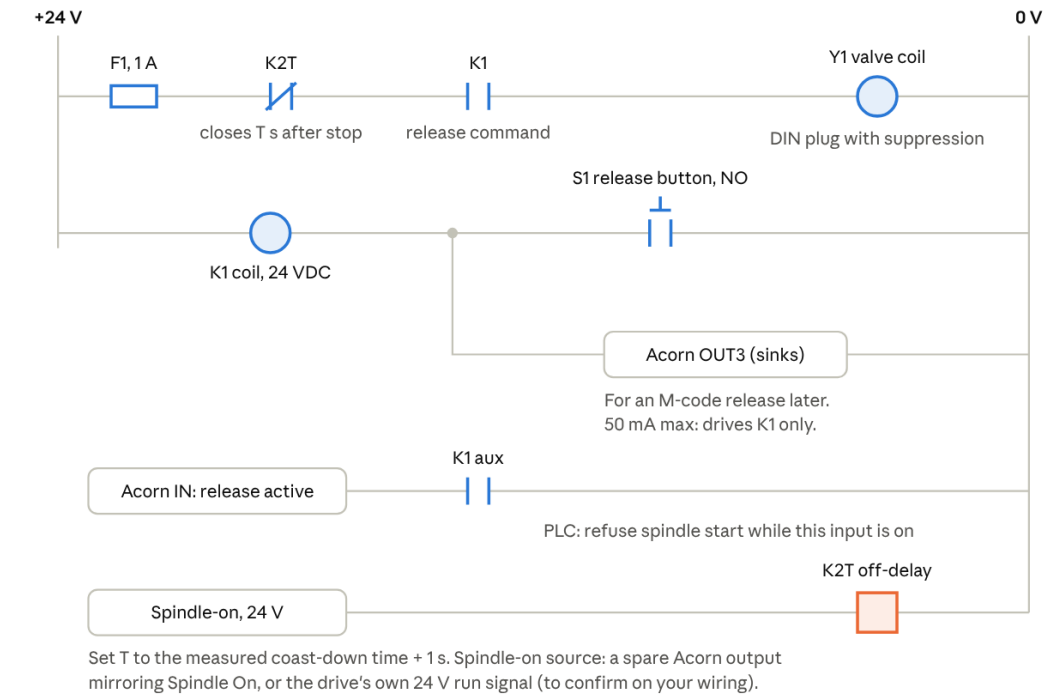
Part	Specification	Why
Filter-regulator	With gauge, set to 5.0 bar	Keeps the cylinder below full supply, which limits the worst-case collar load to about 5.4 kN
5/2 valve	Single solenoid, spring return, 24 VDC coil from the control supply's spare output; 1/4 BSP ports (e.g. Airtac 4V210-08)	De-energised = retract port pressurised = wedge withdrawn, anvil clear
Flow controls	Meter-out, one on each cylinder port (or speed-control silencers on the valve exhausts)	Controls speed in both directions without slamming the wedge into the stop
Silencers	On both valve exhausts	Noise
Tube	10 mm OD polyurethane, push-in fittings (rows 24 and 26)	Each release uses under 1 L of free air, so flow is not critical
Valve relay	Driven by a spare Acorn output; contact rated for the coil	The Acorn's open-collector outputs need a relay to drive a solenoid
Hardware interlock	K2T off-delay contact (opens while the spindle runs and for the coast-down time after) and K1, in series with the valve coil; see Control wiring	Blocks release even if the software misbehaves
Lubricator	Not fitted	Modern cylinders come pre-greased; once air is lubricated it must stay lubricated (general practice, my judgement)

The interlock wiring stays a concept until the spindle drive and the free Acorn inputs and outputs are confirmed.

Control wiring (draft). The valve is switched by its own relay, K1, through two hardware interlocks in series: K1 itself, and K2T, an off-delay timer relay on the spindle-on signal. K2T's contact opens the moment the spindle is switched on and only recloses after the coast-down time has passed. The Acorn sees a K1 auxiliary contact so its PLC can refuse a spindle start while the tool is released, and a spare open-collector output can drive K1 for an M-code release later.

Release only when the spindle has stopped: two hardware interlocks in the valve rung

24 VDC ladder, draft. K1 = valve relay, K2T = off-delay timer relay on the spindle-on signal, Y1 = valve coil.



Set T to the measured coast-down time + 1 s. Spindle-on source: a spare Acorn output mirroring Spindle On, or the drive's own 24 V run signal (to confirm on your wiring).

Acorn inputs: 24 V, on when pulled below 5.9 V (switch to 0 V), about 20 mA.
Acorn outputs: 1–2 relays (5 A at 30 VDC); 3–8 open collector (50 mA max).
K2T and K1 are both in the valve rung, so neither a software fault nor a held button can release the tool while the spindle turns.
No reed switch (the cylinder has no magnetic piston). Flyback diode across K1's coil; suppressed DIN plug on Y1.

control wiring · 24 VDC ladder, draft

Acorn I/O facts used (Centroid Acorn spec manual): 8 inputs, optically isolated, 24 VDC, on when pulled below 5.9 V, about 20 mA each; outputs 1–2 are relays rated 5 A at 30 VDC; outputs 3–8 are open collector, 50 mA maximum. The valve coil (a few watts, roughly 0.1–0.2 A at 24 V for a valve like the 4V210, to confirm on the coil label) is over that 50 mA, so it must go through K1.

Still to confirm on your controller: which spare input and output terminals to use; where a 24 V spindle-on signal can be taken without loading the drive's own run input; the spindle's coast-down time from full speed; and how your Acorn software version exposes a spindle-start inhibit and custom M-codes. I could not find Centroid's Wizard function names for a power drawbar in public documentation, so the PLC side is described by function, not by menu name.

Acorn logic, in plain terms. The hardware rungs (K2T and K1 in series with the valve coil) already stop a release while the spindle turns; the PLC adds a second, software layer and reports state. Terminal numbers wait on sheet 9.13.

1. **Inputs and outputs:** one spare input for "release active" from K1's auxiliary contact; one open-collector output (OUT3) to drive K1's coil for an M-code release.

2. **Block spindle start:** while "release active" is on, the PLC refuses to start the spindle and shows a message such as "drawbar released".
3. **Fault on conflict:** if "release active" comes on while the spindle is commanded on (which the hardware should prevent), stop the spindle and raise a fault.
4. **M-code release (later):** the release M-code turns OUT3 on only when the spindle is commanded off and a software timer at least as long as K2T's delay has run since spindle-off; the clamp M-code, or a timeout of about 10 s, turns it off.
5. **Manual button:** S1 drives K1 directly through the hardware rungs, so it works even if the PLC has faulted; the PLC sees it through the same "release active" input.

Commissioning

Set the parts in this order: collet, collar, preload, gaps, hard stop, then air. Each step fixes a reference the next one measures from. With 8 washers and a 1.2 mm stroke the tool should release at about 4.5 bar; a much higher figure means friction, a wrong preload or a sticking collet.

Assembly and adjustment

1. **Collet.** Measure the flat-nose collet's clamped stick-out; it should be 1.5 mm or less, so grind only if it isn't. Clean the spindle taper; anti-seize the collet outside and threads.
2. **Collar.** Slide it down the spline until the shoulder sits on the spindle end face. Torque the six M8 screws evenly to 32 Nm, keeping both joint gaps equal. Scribe a witness line across collar and spindle.
3. **Drawbar and stack.** With a TTS holder in the collet, thread the drawbar fully into the collet and record the turns. Fit the base thrust washer, then the washers in series (alternating), greased with MoS_2, then the top thrust washer and preload nut.
4. **Preload.** Measure the washers' free height, then tighten the nut until the stack measures 8 × (free height − 0.35 mm) between the thrust washers: about 20.4 mm. Fit and lock the jam nut, then the push pad. Check the holder flange is down on the spindle nose: a 0.02 mm feeler should not enter.
5. **Housing and gaps.** Fit the housing on its float pins. Set the fork-to-flange gap at 0.5–1 mm and check the anvil sits about 1 mm clear of the push pad with the wedge retracted. Turn the spindle by hand: nothing may touch.
6. **Hard stop.** With a dial indicator on the push pad, set the stop so the wedge can push the drawbar s_r + 0.3 mm beyond first contact, and never more than about 1.9 mm, or the washers go flat.

Air and first release

1. Close both flow controls, then open each one turn. Set the regulator to 3 bar.
2. Press release. At 3 bar nothing should happen: the cylinder cannot beat the preload. If the tool drops, the preload is low.
3. Raise the pressure in 0.5 bar steps until the holder drops freely. Record the pressure; about 4.5 bar is expected.
4. Set the regulator to 5.0 bar for service, about 0.5 bar above the expected release pressure; this caps the collar load if a collet ever sticks.
5. Adjust the flow controls until extend and retract are smooth, about half a second each, with no slam (my suggestion).

Interlock and fail-safe checks

- Spindle running: press release, nothing happens.
- Spindle just stopped: release stays blocked until the coast-down delay ends.
- Cut power to the valve mid-release: the cylinder retracts and the tool clamps.
- Shut off the air mid-release: the washers clamp the tool.

Run-in

- Cycle 50 tool changes. Check the witness line, the stack height and the holder seating.
- Touch off the same tool 10 times with a change between each; the spread is your tool-length repeatability.

After two weeks and in service

- Re-measure the stack and reset it to height: stacks lose about 5% of force in the first two weeks (Surisa).
- Monthly: inspect the washers for cracks and replace any damaged ones at once; anti-seize or grease between washers every 5,000 cycles or six months (Tormach). Check the witness line.
- Replace the spindle collet when holders stop dropping out freely; Tormach users treat it as a wear item.

Parts list

32 lines for the wedge design: 11 purchased, 11 committed and ready to source, and 10 still proposed until their design is finished. Change the Status column as parts are bought. "Committed" means the design is fixed and the part can be ordered; "Proposed" means its design or size may still change. The lever design's list is List A in Appendix B.

List B: wedge design

Rows 1–8 and 20–29 are common to List A (lever design, Appendix B).

#	Item	Qty	Specification	Source	Waiting on	Status
1	Air cylinder	1	SDA 80 × 25 compact, double-acting (owned)	Owned	—	Purchased
2	R8 collet, 3/4"	as ordered	Flat-nose 3/4" TTS R8, M12 × 1.75 (received 7 Nov 2026); check clamped stick-out is ≤1.5 mm	Ordered	Arrival	Purchased
3	Belleville washers	2 sets (16)	Genuine Tormach 31319 (30.2 × 11.4 × 2.3 mm), sets of 8: one for the stack, one spare	Tormach	Quote from AU Tormach distributor	Committed
4	Drawbar bar	1 m	4140/709M, 16 mm peeled round × 1 m (Edcon 4140RND.16, ordered 29 Oct 2026)	Edcon Steel	—	Purchased
5	Collar blank	1	4140/709M, 65 mm peeled round (Edcon 4140RND.65, ordered 29 Oct 2026) for the 52 OD, Ø64 flange, 64 high collar (needs at least 70 of bar); only 0.5 mm per	Edcon Steel	—	Purchased

#	Item	Qty	Specification	Source	Waiting on	Status
			side to clean up the flange			
6	Push pad and thrust washers	1 bar	4140 from bars already ordered: push pad Ø16 × 8 from the Ø16 drawbar offcut; two thrust washers 32 OD × 11.3 bore, 3 and 4 mm, from the Ø50 bar (or the Ø65 collar offcut); all hardened and tempered with the wedge and anvil	Edcon Steel (ordered bars)	—	Purchased
7	Drawbar nuts	2 + spares	7/16-20 UNF heavy hex nut and jam nut, grade 8	Fastener supplier	—	Purchased
8	Collar clamp screws	6 + 2 spare	M8 × 25 socket head, grade 12.9	Fastener supplier	—	Purchased
9	Wedge and anvil stock	1	4140/709M, 50 mm peeled round (Edcon 4140RND.50, ordered 29 Oct 2026): wedge 80 long, anvil 40 long, plus saw and facing allowance	Edcon Steel	—	Purchased
10	Roof wear plate stock	1	O1 ground flat stock 40 × 5 × 500 (Edcon fgsfl.40.5.500, ordered 29 Oct 2026); wear plate finished 60 × 40 × 5; plus 4 × M3 × 18 cap screws	Edcon Steel	—	Purchased
11	Rollers	4 + 1 spare	Ø14 × 36 mm hardened, ground dowel pins, ISO 8734, 58–62 HRC (supplier spec)	Purchased	—	Purchased
12	Roller cage and springs	1 set	2 cages from 2 mm brass sheet; 4 light compression springs Ø5 × 16 free (about 0.1 N/mm); 4 × Ø5 silver-steel cross pins with e-clips (Ø5 W1 silver steel ordered from Edcon, 2 ×	Engineering supplier	Brass sheet still to buy; silver steel, springs and e-clips bought	Committed

#	Item	Qty	Specification	Source	Waiting on	Status
			1 m)			
13	Floating joint	1	SMC JA40-14-150 floating joint, M14 × 1.5, rated 4,400 N tension/compression, plus an M14 × 1.5 × 40 grade 10.9 or 12.9 stud (or fine-thread bolt with the head cut off) into the rod; check the joint's overall length against the rod-to-wedge gap	Pneumatics supplier	—	Purchased
14	Housing side plates	2	12 mm 6060, 130 × 189, a mirrored pair: fork window, collar notch, anvil lift pockets and all holes as the side plate drawing	Aluminium supplier	—	Purchased
15	Roof block	1	6061-T6, 19 × 60 × 42 mm finished (from 20 mm plate; 19 because the wear plate is 5 mm); 4 × Ø3.4 holes counterbored Ø6.5 × 3.5 for M3 × 18	Aluminium supplier (stock received 6 Nov 2026)	—	Purchased
16	Cylinder mount plate	1	12 mm 6060, 100 × 100, Ø40 centre bore; 4 × M12 × 1.75 socket heads into the cylinder's front threads; 4 × M6 × 25 into the side plates' front edges; spacer tubes on the M12s if the JA joint needs more room	Aluminium supplier (12 × 160 bar), fastener supplier	—	Purchased
17	Fork plate	1	16 mm mild steel, 92 × 66, slot 54 wide with an R27 end; slides through the side-plate windows under the collar flange and rests on the plates' feet; 4 × M6 × 30 up through the feet	Steel supplier	—	Purchased

#	Item	Qty	Specification	Source	Waiting on	Status
18	Anvil parts	1 set	Rear thrust bar, 6061-T6 10 × 30 × 42, faced with a 3 × 25 × 40 bronze strip; 2 × Ø5 m6 × 10 dowel pins (ISO 8734) as lift pins, pressed into the reamed H7 holes; 2 light springs under them	Engineering supplier	Bronze strip still to buy; bar stock, dowels and springs ordered 6 Nov 2026	Committed
19	Hard stop	1	M8 set screw and lock nut in a rear stop block (6061-T6 10 × 20 × 42) between the side plates	Fastener supplier	—	Purchased
20	Float guides	2 sets	2 × Ø12 h6 ground rod 140 long (M8 × 11 spigot turned on one end); 2 lugs (6061-T6 40 × 24 × 20) with Ø12/Ø16 × 20 bronze bushes; 4 × Ø22 × 10 set-screw collars; 2 compression springs, about 13 ID × 20 free, about 3 N/mm, fitted at 12 long (about 24 N each)	Bearing or engineering supplier	Ø12 ground rod still to buy; lugs, bushes, collars and springs bought	Committed
21	Head-top base plate	1	12 mm 6060 replacing the belt cover: outline flush with the head top, R47 cut-out round the spindle opening into an 80 wide slot to the rear for the belt; 4 × M6 × 20 (8.8) into new holes tapped through the 9 mm casting top; 2 × Ø6 dowels; carries the two float guide pins (see the base plate drawing)	Aluminium supplier (12 × 160 bar)	—	Purchased
22	Filter-regulator	1	With gauge, 1/4" ports, set to 5.0 bar	Pneumatics supplier	—	Committed
23	Solenoid valve	1	5/2 single solenoid, spring return, 24 VDC	Pneumatics supplier	Ordered 6 Nov 2026	Purchased
24	Flow controls	2	Meter-out, push-in, 10 mm tube × R3/8, in place of the PC10-03	Pneumatics supplier	Port thread	Purchased

#	Item	Qty	Specification	Source	Waiting on	Status
			fittings			
25	Silencers	2	To suit the valve exhaust ports	Pneumatics supplier	Valve choice	Purchased
26	Tube and fittings	1 lot	10 mm PU tube about 3 m; PC10-02 fittings for the valve's 1/4 BSP ports	Pneumatics supplier	On hand (6 Nov 2026); confirm about 3 m of 10 mm tube and 3 × PC10-02	Purchased
27	Release button	1	Momentary pushbutton, panel mount, front faceplate	Electrical supplier	—	Committed
28	Valve relay	1	K1: 24 VDC coil drawing under 50 mA (so an Acorn open-collector output can drive it), contacts rated at least 1 A DC, one spare NO for the Acorn input; flyback diode	Electrical supplier	Acorn I/O	Proposed
29	Consumables	1 lot	MoS_2 grease, anti-seize, thread-locker	Hardware store	—	Committed
30	Timer relay K2T	1	24 VDC multifunction DIN-rail timer relay with an off-delay (delay-on-release) mode, adjustable about 0.5–10 s	Electrical supplier	Spindle-on signal source	Proposed
31	Fuse and terminals	1 lot	F1 1 A fuse and DIN-rail holder; DIN-rail terminals; 1N4007 flyback diode	Electrical supplier	—	Committed
32	Z-axis gas strut	1	Stroke at least 250 mm; extended force about 0.7 × the measured head weight; bleed-valve type; eye or M8 ball-joint ends	Gas spring supplier	Head weight measurement	Proposed

Ready to order now (the Committed rows of List B, grouped by supplier)

Supplier	Rows	Order
Tormach AU	3	2 sets of 31319 washers (16), quote pending

Supplier	Rows	Order
distributor		
Edcon Steel (ordered 29 Oct 2026)	4, 5, 6, 9, 10, 12	4140/709M peeled round: Ø16 × 1 m, Ø50 × 150, Ø65 for the collar; O1 ground flat stock 40 × 5 × 500; Ø5 W1 silver steel 2 × 1 m
Aluminium supplier	14, 15, 16, 18, 19, 20, 21	6061-T6, except the 12 × 160 flat bar, which is 6060 (temper to confirm). Flat bar 12 × 160, at least 608 long (650 recommended): side plates 2 × 130 × 189, base plate (115 × 107) and mount plate (100 × 100) cut one after another along the bar. Plate or bar 20 × 65 × 50: roof block (19 × 60 × 42 finished). Flat 10 × 30 × 100: thrust bar and stop block (42 each). Flat 25 × 20 × 100: two lugs (40 × 24 × 20 finished). Ordered and received 6 Nov 2026: the 20 × 65 × 50 roof block stock and both flats. 12 × 160 flat bar, 1000 long, purchased 6 Nov 2026 (the 400 × 250 plate couldn't be sourced).
Engineering supplier	12, 17, 18, 20	Mild steel 16 × 100 × 70 (fork plate, purchased 6 Nov 2026); 2 mm brass sheet about 100 × 50 (cages); bronze strip 3 × 25 × 40; Ø12 h6 ground rod, one length at least 300 for 2 × 140 (unhardened ground bar is easier to turn the M8 spigot on than induction-hardened linear shaft); 2 bronze bushes Ø12/Ø16 × 20; 4 × Ø12 shaft collars
Gas spring supplier	32	Z-axis gas strut, once the head weight is measured (see Z-axis gas strut)
Fasteners	7, 8, and the hardware list	Everything in the hardware list below: screws, dowels, springs, e-clips and thread inserts
Pneumatics	22, 23, 26	Filter-regulator with gauge, 1/4″; 5/2 single-solenoid, spring-return valve, 24 VDC, 1/4 BSP (for example 4V210-08), with an LED and suppression DIN plug; 10 mm PU tube about 3 m; 2 × PC10-02 for the valve plus a fitting for the regulator
Electrical	27, 31	Momentary NO panel pushbutton; 1 A fuse and DIN-rail holder; DIN-rail terminals; 1N4007 diode
Hardware store	29	MoS_2 grease, anti-seize, thread-locker

The floating joint (row 13) can be ordered as the SMC JA40-14-150, whose 4,400 N rating covers the load; confirm its length against the rod-to-wedge gap first. The head measurements are in and the housing stock was bought on 6 Nov 2026.

Hardware list (wedge design). Every screw, pin and small bought part in one place. Lengths are checked against the parts they pass through; grade 8.8 unless stated.

Item	Qty	Size and spec	Where	Status
Socket head cap screw	6 + 2 spare	M8 × 25, grade 12.9	Collar clamp	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Heavy hex nut and jam nut	1 + 1, plus spares	7/16-20 UNF, grade 8	Drawbar preload	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Stud	1	M14 × 1.5 × 40, grade 10.9 or 12.9 (or a fine-thread bolt with the head cut off)	Cylinder rod to JA joint	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Thin nut	1	M14 × 1.5 (if not supplied with the JA)	JA stud, locked against the wedge end	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Socket head cap screw	4	M12 × (35 + spacer length); through the 12 mm plate this engages 9 mm of the cylinder's 14 mm thread	Cylinder to mount plate	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Spacer tube	4	Ø13 ID, length set from the JA measurement (may be none)	Behind the cylinder	Not ordered: length set after the JA measurement
Socket head cap screw	4	M6 × 25	Mount plate to side-plate front edges	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Socket head cap screw	4	M8 × 25	Roof block to side plates	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Dowel pin, ISO 8734	2	Ø6 m6 × 20	Roof block to side plates	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Socket head cap screw	4	M3 × 18	Roof block down into the wear plate	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Socket head cap screw	8	M5 × 20	Thrust bar and stop block ends	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Countersunk screw	2	M3 × 8	Bronze strip to thrust bar	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Hex set screw and nut	1 + 1	M8 × 30, full thread	Hard stop	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Socket head cap screw	4	M6 × 30	Fork plate, up through the feet	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Socket head cap screw	4	M6 × 35	Float lugs to side plates	Ordered 6 Nov 2026

Item	Qty	Size and spec	Where	Status
Socket head cap screw	4	M6 × 20: through the 12 mm plate, 8 mm into the 9 mm casting top, so nothing pokes through	Base plate to head	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Dowel pin, ISO 8734	2	Ø6 m6 × 16	Base plate to head	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Dowel pin, ISO 8734	2	Ø5 m6 × 10	Anvil lift pins	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Shaft collar, set-screw type	4	Ø12 bore	Float guide rest and top collars	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Sintered bronze bush	2	Ø12 × Ø16 × 20	Float lugs	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Compression spring	2	to suit Ø12 pin, about 20 free, about 3 N/mm	Float hold-down, about 24 N fitted	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Compression spring	4	Ø5 × 16 free, about 0.1 N/mm	Roller cages	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Compression spring	2	to fit a Ø6 pocket, about 10 free, 1–2 N fitted	Anvil lift	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
E-clip, DIN 6799	8	for Ø5 shaft	Cage cross pins	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Thread insert, Helicoil type	4	M6, 1.5 × d long	Side plates' front edges, for the mount-plate screws (removed with the cylinder)	Ordered 6 Nov 2026
Thread insert, Helicoil type (optional)	4	M8, 1.5 × d long	Roof block ends, if the box will be taken apart often	Ordered 6 Nov 2026

Open items

The release stroke is the critical input; most other dimensions follow from it.

- ☐ Release stroke s_r: section 5 test with the new 3/4" collet and a temporary M12 × 1.75 drawbar (grade 8.8 threaded rod, nut and a thick washer on the spindle end face) at about 20 Nm dry or 15 Nm oiled
- ☐ Collet thread length and engagement (rows 3.5–3.7)
- ☐ Measure the flat-nose collet's clamped stick-out at design preload: it must be 1.5 mm or less, at least 0.5 mm under the 2.0 mm holder rebate; grind only if it isn't
- ☐ Taper break effort: first estimate of push-out force P
- ☐ Spline profile: crest width, root diameter, hardness (file test) for the cap clamp
- ☐ Air supply: 90 psi at 9 CFM confirmed; still need compressor cut-in pressure and fittings at the mill
- ☐ Controller: 24 VDC for the valve is available from the spare supply outputs; still need the spindle-on signal source and spare Acorn I/O (sheet 9.13)

- ☐ Washers fixed at 8 × Tormach 31319: check the release stroke is within about 1.2 mm (1.6 mm at 5.5 bar); if not, fit a genuine Tormach collet. Measure the washers' free height before setting preload
- ☐ Order 2 sets of genuine Tormach 31319 (16 washers)
- ☐ File-test the spline: if it is soft, the grooved, positive-hold collar is available as a fallback
- ☐ Pilot-drill, or look under the head top, at the four new M6 base-plate positions to make sure they miss any ribs
- ☐ Spindle coast-down time (sheet 9.12) to set the K2T off-delay
- ☐ Measure the JA40-14-150 fitted to the rod, cylinder retracted: from the cylinder front face to the face of the JA's stud nut. Up to 30 mm fits as drawn; anything over 30 mm is the length of the spacer tubes behind the cylinder
- ☐ Cylinder rod side play (sheet 7.13), for information
- ☐ Quick check: the cylinder's rod boss is under Ø38, so it clears the mount plate's Ø40 bore (only matters if no spacers are needed)
- ☐ Lengths of the Ø16 and Ø65 bars as delivered, against the cutting list: the Ø65 needs at least 70 for the 64 mm collar (84 if the thrust washers come from it); the Ø50 is 150, which is enough
- ☐ Head weight W for the gas strut: Z coupling undone, luggage scale, average of the just-rising and just-falling readings; then the strut's column and head bracket positions
- ☒ Alloy of the 12 × 160 flat bar: 6060 (confirmed 7 Nov 2026). Confirm the temper from the label or certificate (T5 assumed)
- ☐ Still to buy: Ø12 h6 ground rod (at least 300), bronze strip 3 × 25 × 40, 2 mm brass sheet about 100 × 50, filter-regulator
- ☐ Make a temporary M12 × 1.75 test drawbar (grade 8.8 threaded rod about 300 long, nut, thick washer) for the release-stroke test
- ☐ Choose K1 and K2T once the Acorn spare I/O and the spindle-on signal are confirmed (sheet 9.13)
- ☐ Design the gas strut brackets on the column and head once W is measured
- ☐ Settle the valve and regulator mounting positions (see Air lines and valve)

Appendix A – Washer suppliers

Tormach is the only source found with a published price and stock for a 30 mm high-load drawbar washer: US$4.95 each. Everything else is quote-only, and none of the US sources shows shipping to Australia. Prices are as listed on 27 Oct 2026.

Spec to quote against

- About 30 mm OD; bore 11.3–11.5 mm (clears the 7/16" thread, guides on an 11.2 mm section); 2.3–2.5 mm thick
- Free height about 2.9–3.1 mm (cone height about 0.6 mm); flat load about 13–15 kN
- Hardened spring steel or 17-7PH; not 304 stainless
- About 24 pieces from one batch (20 for the stack plus spares); fewer if the release stroke is short

Supplier	Part	OD × bore × t (mm)	Load data	Price and availability	Notes
Tormach (US)	31319 Power Drawbar Spring Washer	30.2 × 11.4 × 2.3	Not published	US$4.95 each, in stock; ask Tormach about shipping to Australia	Made for 7/16" R8 drawbars, the proven reference part
Solon (US), via	7H89177	30.2 × 11.4	15.1 kN flat	Not listed	17-7PH; the basis for this

Supplier	Part	OD × bore × t (mm)	Load data	Price and availability	Notes
distributors		× 2.44, height 3.07	at 0.64 mm		design's sizing. Specify 7H89177: the 7H89301 (301 stainless, height 3.63) is a different washer at 12.0 kN flat
McMaster-Carr (US)	9712K436	Not confirmed	About 8.4 kN working load (builder's figure)	Not checked	Used on a PM728 build; check whether McMaster will ship to you
Bell Springs (Melbourne)	Quote to the spec above	—	—	Earlier DIN A50 quote: $131; re-quote to this spec	Local, no import freight; 03 9464 6611, sales@bellsprings.com.au
Belleville Springs (UK)	CW29133 heavy-duty bolting washer	29 × 13 × 3, height 3.95	34.1 kN flat	Contact	Not recommended: about 36 kN/mm, so about 30 washers for a 2.5 mm stroke, and the 13 mm bore needs a guide sleeve

Newcastle Hi-Tensile Bolt (NSW) sells disc springs online in single quantities, but its M12 range tops out at 1.5 mm thick, too light for this stack.

Decision. Genuine Tormach 31319, two sets of 8 (US$79 before shipping): one set in the stack, one spare. The other suppliers are kept for reference.

Care in service. Tormach says to inspect the stack monthly for cracks, replace damaged washers immediately, and apply anti-seize between washers every 5,000 cycles or six months (Tormach power drawbar maintenance).

Appendix B – Lever actuator (alternative)

The 6:1 lever on a floating yoke was the first design. It works, and it is kept here for reference. The wedge in the main body was chosen for its lower mass (about 4.9 kg against 8.5 kg), lower height (about Z 152 against Z 275) and flat anvil contact. The collar, drawbar, washer stack, cylinder, pneumatics and controls are common to both.

Lever or wedge

	Lever (Appendix B)	Wedge (chosen)
Estimated mass, cylinder weighed at 1.2 kg	About 8.5 kg	About 4.9 kg
Height above the spindle end face	Top plate at about Z 250 to 275	About Z 152
Centre of gravity	High; cylinder above the lever	Low; cylinder level with the wedge

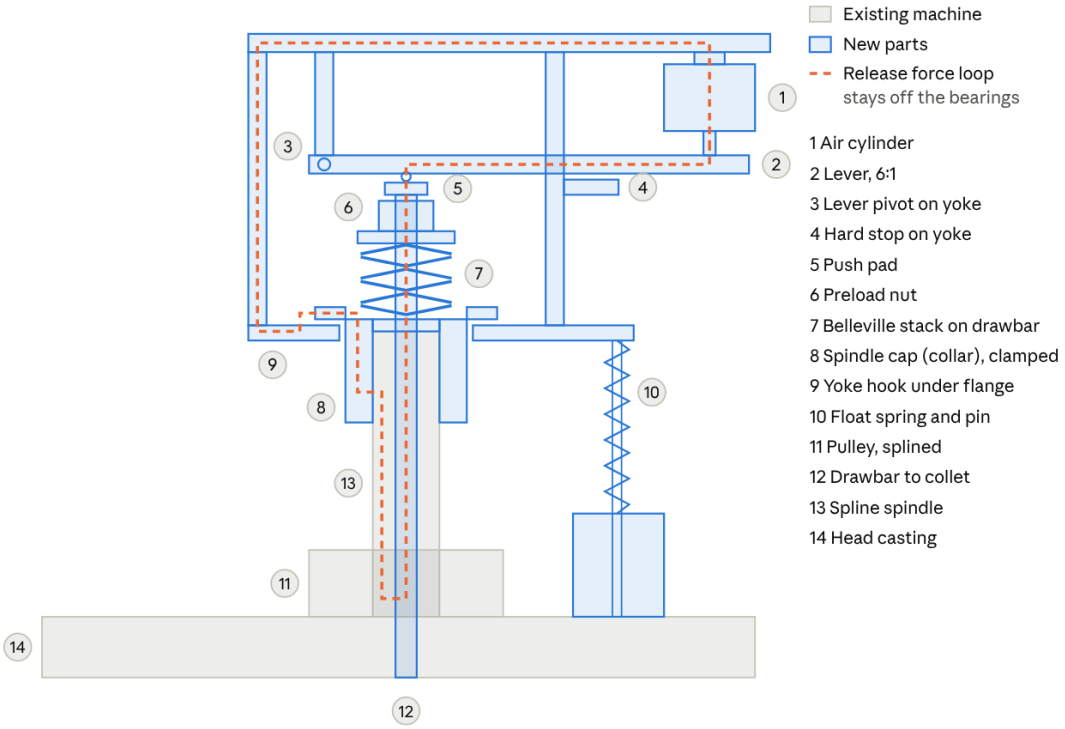
	Lever (Appendix B)	Wedge (chosen)
Contact on the push pad	R30 line contact, about 1,300 MPa	Flat anvil, 84 MPa
Hardened, ground parts	Nose insert, push pad	Wedge, anvil, roof plate, 4 rollers, push pad
Machines needed	Mill and lathe	Mill, lathe and surface grinder (all available)
Cylinder mount	Clevis at both ends	Front face bolted, floating joint on the rod
Ratio adjustment	Slotted pivot, 5–6:1	Fixed; new wedge and anvil
Main risk	Weight and height on the head	Roller load sharing and cage creep

Mass breakdown (my estimates from part sizes; the SDA 80 × 25 weighed 1.199 kg with fittings)

- **Lever:** top plate 1.8 kg, side plates 1.85, lever 1.0, pivot cheeks 0.7, fork 0.6, clevis plates and pins 0.9, float lugs and stop 0.4, cylinder 1.2: about 8.5 kg. The side plates and cheeks grew with the 22 mm taller yoke, which cancels the lighter cylinder.
- **Wedge (updated 29 Oct 2026):** side plates 1.40 kg, cylinder 1.20, wedge and anvil 0.66, fork 0.40 (steel), mount plate 0.28, roof block and wear plate 0.22, JA joint and stud 0.21, rollers 0.17, lugs 0.10, small parts about 0.3: about 4.9 kg floating, plus about 0.5 kg of base plate and guide pins fixed to the head. Most of the frame is 6061-T6; only the fork and the hardened parts are steel.

The release force closes in the yoke, not the bearings

Schematic section, not to scale. Quill locked up; actuator shown at rest.



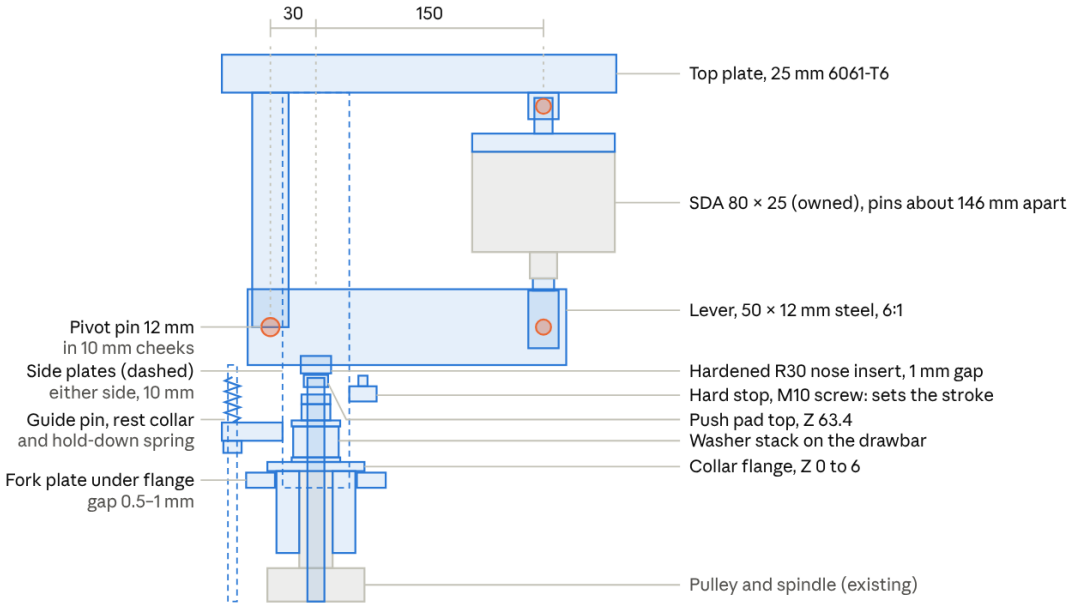
concept section · floating yoke, lever and cylinder over the spindle cap

Yoke and lever layout (draft)

The yoke is a rigid frame: a fork plate under the collar flange, two side plates, and a top plate carrying the lever pivot and the cylinder. The lever pivots 30 mm behind the drawbar axis and the cylinder acts 150 mm in front of it, giving 6:1. Everything below the top plate is fixed now; with the measured cylinder the top plate sits at about Z 250 to 275; the guide-pin positions still wait on the head-side measurements.

A 6:1 lever on a floating yoke: the layout to build from

Side view, about 1 px per mm from the spindle end face. Bracket and guide-pin positions wait on the head measurements.



Draft, 8 × Tormach 31319 and SDA 80 × 25: pad top Z 63.4, rod pin Z 95, rear pin about Z 241, top plate Z 250 to 275.

yoke and lever layout · side view, draft

Geometry (X from the drawbar axis toward the cylinder, Z up from the spindle end face, mm; 8-washer stack)

Point	X	Z	Notes
Push pad top	0	63.4	From the stack-up
Nose contact at rest	0	64.4	1 mm running gap
Lever pivot	−30	95	Lever centreline
Cylinder rod pin	+150	95	180 mm from the pivot, so 6:1
Cylinder rear pin	+150	95 + L ≈ 241	L = pin-to-pin length, about 146 mm (30 + 78.5 + 37), ±5 mm on the rod clevis thread
Top plate underside	—	about 95 + L + 9 ≈ 250	Rear clevis cheeks hang 18 mm
Fork plate top	±46 to ±27	−0.5 to −1	Under the flange underside at Z 0
Hard stop	+30	Adjust	The lever moves 2 × the drawbar travel here

The lever runs toward the back of the head: the spindle is 60 mm from the front, leaving about 195 mm behind it, and the cylinder sits well above the pulleys.

Load check (my calculations; full 6.2 bar supply as the worst case, 5.0 bar setting in brackets)

Member	Load	Section	Stress	Verdict
Cylinder push	3.12 (2.51) kN	—	—	—
Drawbar push (η 0.9)	16.8 (13.6) kN	—	—	—
Pivot pin	about 15.6 (12.6) kN	12 mm, double shear	69 MPa shear; 108 MPa bearing in the lever	OK for hardened pin and mild steel
Lever at the nose	468 (377) N·m	50 × 12 mm, Z = 5,000 mm^3	94 (75) MPa	OK; mild steel yields about 250 MPa (from memory)
Nose on push pad	16.8 (13.6) kN	R30 line contact, 12 mm wide	about 1,300 (1,170) MPa Hertz peak	Needs a hardened insert and pad, at least about 55 HRC
Top plate	about 0.41 kN·m	25 × 100 mm 6061-T6	about 40 MPa	OK; about 240 MPa yield (from memory)
Side plates	16.8 kN tension, shared	2 × 10 × 40 mm	21 MPa	OK
Fork under flange	16.8 kN	2 contacts, about 6 × 40 mm	35 MPa	OK
Hard stop	up to about 6.2 kN	M10 screw	Low	OK

A nose, not a roller. At up to 17 kN, a small rolling bearing is far beyond its rating; a 608 is about 1.4 kN static (from memory). A hardened R30 nose insert on the hardened push pad carries it as line contact. The nose rolls and slides about 4 mm across the 16 mm pad over the stroke; keep it greased.

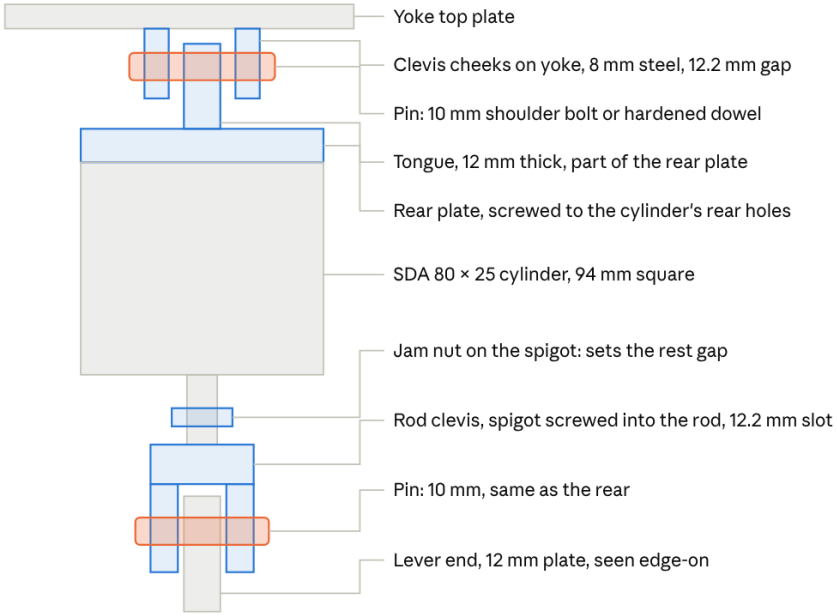
Float and rest. The yoke sits by gravity on adjustable stop collars on two 12 mm guide pins fixed to the head-side brackets; the collars set the 0.5–1 mm hook gap. Light compression springs above the bushes hold it down against Z-axis decelerations, with preload about equal to the yoke's weight. On release the yoke lifts by the hook gap and all force stays inside the loop. The mass estimate is about 8.5 kg with the cylinder (see the comparison at the start of this appendix), so check that the Z axis and any head counterbalance can carry it.

Lever cylinder mounts

The SDA 80 × 25 hangs from the yoke on a pinned clevis at each end. The cylinder then swings with the lever, and its short rod bearing carries only axial load. Loads are small (3.1 kN maximum), so the parts are sized for stiffness and easy machining, not strength. The cylinder's measured dimensions are under Cylinder in the main body.

Both ends pivot, so the lever arc puts no side load on the rod

View along the lever, pins horizontal. Schematic, not to scale.



Both pins parallel to the lever pivot. The spigot thread gives about ±5 mm of length adjustment; pins about 146 mm apart.

cylinder mounts · rear clevis, rod clevis, pins

Pin-to-pin length. Because the rod is female-threaded, the rod clevis gets an integral male spigot. My layout values: rear pin 30 mm behind the rear face (12 mm plate + 18 mm to the pin), 78.5 mm of cylinder and rod, and 37 mm from the rod face to the rod pin (8 mm jam nut, 5 mm adjustment, 24 mm of clevis). That gives L ≈ 146 mm, with the rear pin at about Z 241 and the top plate at about Z 250 to 275.

Rear clevis plate (on the cylinder)

Feature	Dimension and notes
Material	6061-T6 aluminium or mild steel, from one block (about 40 mm thick before machining)
Plate	94 × 94 mm (the body is 94.07 mm square) × 12 mm thick
Fixing	4 socket head screws into the cylinder's rear tapped holes, M12 × 1.75 on a 74.07 mm square, with the thread starting 14 mm below the face and running 14 mm. M12 × 35 socket heads through the 12 mm plate (heads on the plate face, not counterbored) give about 9 mm of engagement and stop about 5 mm short of the end of the thread. That is under the usual 1.5 × d, but each screw carries only about 0.8 kN, so I estimate the margin on stripping is still well over 10×
Location	If the rear face has a boss or recess, machine a matching spigot so the tongue sits on the cylinder axis
Tongue	12 mm thick × 30 mm wide, centred, projecting 30 mm; end radius R15
Pin hole	10 mm H8, 18 mm from the plate face, square to the tongue faces

Yoke rear bracket (double clevis)

Feature	Dimension and notes
Cheeks	Two 8 mm mild steel plates, 12.2 +0.2/0 mm apart, bolted or welded to the yoke top plate
Pin hole	10 mm H8, drilled and reamed through both cheeks in one pass so they line up
Orientation	Pin axis parallel to the lever pivot, about 0.2 mm in 100 mm (my judgement)

Rod clevis

Feature	Dimension and notes
Material	Mild steel or 4140 offcut, about 30 mm square × 38 mm, with an integral threaded spigot
Rod connection	The rod is female-threaded M14 × 1.5, 33 mm deep, so the clevis has an M14 × 1.5 spigot about 26 mm long: 21 mm (1.5 × d) of engagement plus about 5 mm for adjustment, and at least 7 mm clear of the bottom of the hole
Lock	M14 × 1.5 thin jam nut (DIN 439, 8 mm) on the spigot, locked against the rod end; the screwed length sets the lever's rest gap
Slot	12.2 +0.2/0 mm wide × 28 mm deep; cheeks 9 mm each
Pin hole	10 mm H8, 14 mm from the end, square to the slot

Pins and lever end

Feature	Dimension and notes
Pins	10 mm hardened: ISO 7379 shoulder bolt with nyloc nut, or a dowel with e-clips; lightly greased
Lever end	12 mm steel plate, R15 end, 10 mm H8 hole, or a 10 mm flanged bronze bush for wear

Load check (my calculation; rod diameter 25 mm, measured)

Item	Value
Maximum push, 80 mm bore at 6.2 bar	3.12 kN
Maximum pull on retract, 25 mm rod, 6.2 bar (2.27 kN at 5.0 bar)	about 2.81 kN
Pin shear, 10 mm in double shear	about 20 MPa
Bearing, 10 mm pin in a 12 mm tongue	about 26 MPa
Rear screws, 4 off	about 0.8 kN each

All of these are a small fraction of what 6061-T6 or mild steel takes, so there is room to thin the parts if the yoke layout needs it.

Kinematics. The rod pin sits 180 mm from the lever pivot. The normal release (13.2 mm of cylinder travel) turns the lever about 4.2°, the hard stop (15 mm) about 4.8°, and the washer-flat limit (17.4 mm) about 5.5°. The rod pin moves sideways at most about 0.8 mm, which swings the cylinder about 0.3° on its rear pin with L ≈ 146 mm, well within normal pin clearances.

Option. If you can't hold the pins parallel to the lever pivot, use a female spherical rod end (heim joint) on a stud adapter in place of the rod clevis. It tolerates a few degrees of out-of-plane misalignment.

List A: lever design

#	Item	Qty	Specification	Source	Waiting on	Status
1	Air cylinder	1	SDA 80 × 25 compact, double-acting (owned; the SDA 80 × 30 from AliExpress is a spare)	Owned	—	Purchased
2	R8 collet, 3/4"	as ordered	Flat-nose 3/4" TTS R8, M12 × 1.75 (received 7 Nov 2026); check clamped stick-out is ≤1.5 mm	Ordered	Arrival	Purchased
3	Belleville washers	2 sets (16)	Genuine Tormach 31319 (30.2 × 11.4 × 2.3 mm), sold in sets of 8: one set for the stack, one spare set	Tormach (US$4.95 each, US$79 for 16)	Quote from AU Tormach Distributor	Committed
4	Drawbar bar	1 m	4140 condition T, 16 mm round	Collier & Miller, The Metal Warehouse, Russell Steel	—	Committed
5	Collar blank	1	4140 condition T, 66 mm round × 70 mm (52 OD, 64 flange, 60 high)	Russell Steel, or a club offcut	—	Committed
6	Push pad and thrust washers	1 bar	Silver steel, 35 mm round × 50 mm: pad 16 × 8 mm, two thrust washers 32 OD × 11.3 bore, 3 and 4 mm, all hardened and tempered	Engineering supplier	—	Committed
7	Drawbar nuts	2 + spares	7/16-20 UNF heavy hex nut and jam nut, grade 8	Fastener supplier	—	Committed
8	Collar clamp screws	6 + 2 spare	M8 × 25 socket head, grade 12.9	Fastener supplier	—	Committed
9	Clevis pins	2	10 mm hardened shoulder bolt, ISO 7379, about 10 × 30–35 shoulder, M8 nyloc nut	Fastener supplier	Cheek widths	Committed
10	Rear clevis plate blank	1	6061-T6, 94 mm square × 40 mm thick, plus 4 × M12 × 35 socket head	Metal supplier	—	Committed

#	Item	Qty	Specification	Source	Waiting on	Status
			screws			
11	Rod clevis blank	1	Mild steel or 4140, 30 mm square × 70 mm (38 mm body plus an M14 × 1.5 spigot turned from the solid), plus an M14 × 1.5 thin jam nut	Metal supplier or offcut	—	Committed
12	Lever nose insert	1	Silver steel or O1, 12 × 20 × 25 mm, R30 contact face, hardened	Engineering supplier	—	Committed
13	Lever	1	Mild steel flat, 50 × 12 mm × about 220 mm	Steel supplier	Yoke layout	Proposed
14	Yoke plates	1 set	Top plate 6061-T6 25 mm; side plates and pivot cheeks 10 mm steel; fork plate 10 mm steel	Steel and aluminium supplier	Yoke layout, cylinder length	Proposed
15	Pivot pin	1	12 mm hardened dowel or shoulder bolt, double shear	Fastener supplier	Yoke layout	Proposed
16	Float guides	2 sets	12 mm ground rod, 12 mm bronze bushes, stop collars, light compression springs	Bearing or engineering supplier	Head brackets	Proposed
17	Side brackets	2	10 mm steel plate; new tapped holes in the head sides	Steel supplier	Head-side measurements	Proposed
18	Hard stop	1	M10 set screw and lock nut in a lug under the lever	Fastener supplier	Yoke layout	Proposed
19	Filter-regulator	1	With gauge, 1/4" ports, set to 5.0 bar	Pneumatics supplier	—	Committed
20	Solenoid valve	1	5/2 single solenoid, spring return, 24 VDC	Pneumatics supplier	—	Committed
21	Flow controls	2	Meter-out, push-in, 10 mm tube × R3/8, in place of the PC10-03 fittings	Pneumatics supplier	Port thread	Committed
22	Silencers	2	To suit the valve exhaust ports	Pneumatics supplier	Valve choice	Committed

#	Item	Qty	Specification	Source	Waiting on	Status
23	Tube and fittings	1 lot	10 mm PU tube about 3 m (matches the PC10-03 fittings); PC10-02 fittings for the valve's 1/4 BSP ports	Pneumatics supplier	—	Committed
24	Release button	1	Momentary pushbutton, panel mount, front faceplate	Electrical supplier	—	Committed
25	Valve relay	1	24 VDC coil, contact rated for the valve coil	Electrical supplier	Acorn I/O	Proposed
26	24 VDC supply	1	Not needed: the control power supply has a spare 24 VDC output	Electrical supplier	Acorn I/O	Proposed
27	Reed switch	1	Not possible with the owned SDA 80×25: no magnetic piston (measured)	Pneumatics supplier	Cylinder check	Proposed
28	Consumables	1 lot	MoS_2 grease, anti-seize, thread-locker	Hardware store	—	Committed

Sources

- SX2.3 manual EN (spindle taper, travel)
- CNCzone – G0704 Power Drawbar Question (Hoss floating lever)
- LinuxCNC G0704 – Hydraulic Power Drawbar (Hoss PDB v2, no bearing load)
- Shane Wighton – Power Drawbar for X2 Mini Mill
- CNCArena – Manual Power Drawbar (Hoss TTS force guidance)
- CNCzone – Power draw bar idea, feasible? (release force vs clamp force)
- Tormach TTS Adapter Collet R8 (50568)
- Tormach – Power drawbar parts lists
- McMaster-Carr – R8 collets (grip tolerance)
- Fasten.it – DIN 2093 disc spring dimensions and loads
- Wikipedia – Belleville washer (stacking, 3 × OD stack-height guide)
- CNCArena – viking45 (Tormach 31319 washer dimensions)
- Solon 7H89177 Belleville spring washer (7/16" size, flat load)
- Hobby-Machinist – PM728 power drawbar (McMaster 9712K436 washers)
- Hobby-Machinist – shop-built CNC mill PDB (6 washers in series)
- Surisa – DIN 2093 guiding, hardness and relaxation
- SMC – JA/JAH floating joint catalogue (JA40-14-150: M14 × 1.5, 40 mm bore, 4,400 N max tension/compression, 0.75 mm eccentricity, ±5°, installation notes)
- Atlas Steels – 4140 through-hardening bar datasheet (supply condition, hardening 850–860 °C oil, tempering 175–230 °C, 230–370 °C to avoid)
- Edcon Steel – O1 flat ground stock 40 × 5 × 500
- Edcon Steel – Gauge plate (O1) range

- Johnson, K. L., *Contact Mechanics*, Cambridge University Press, 1985: line-contact first yield and shakedown (cited from memory)